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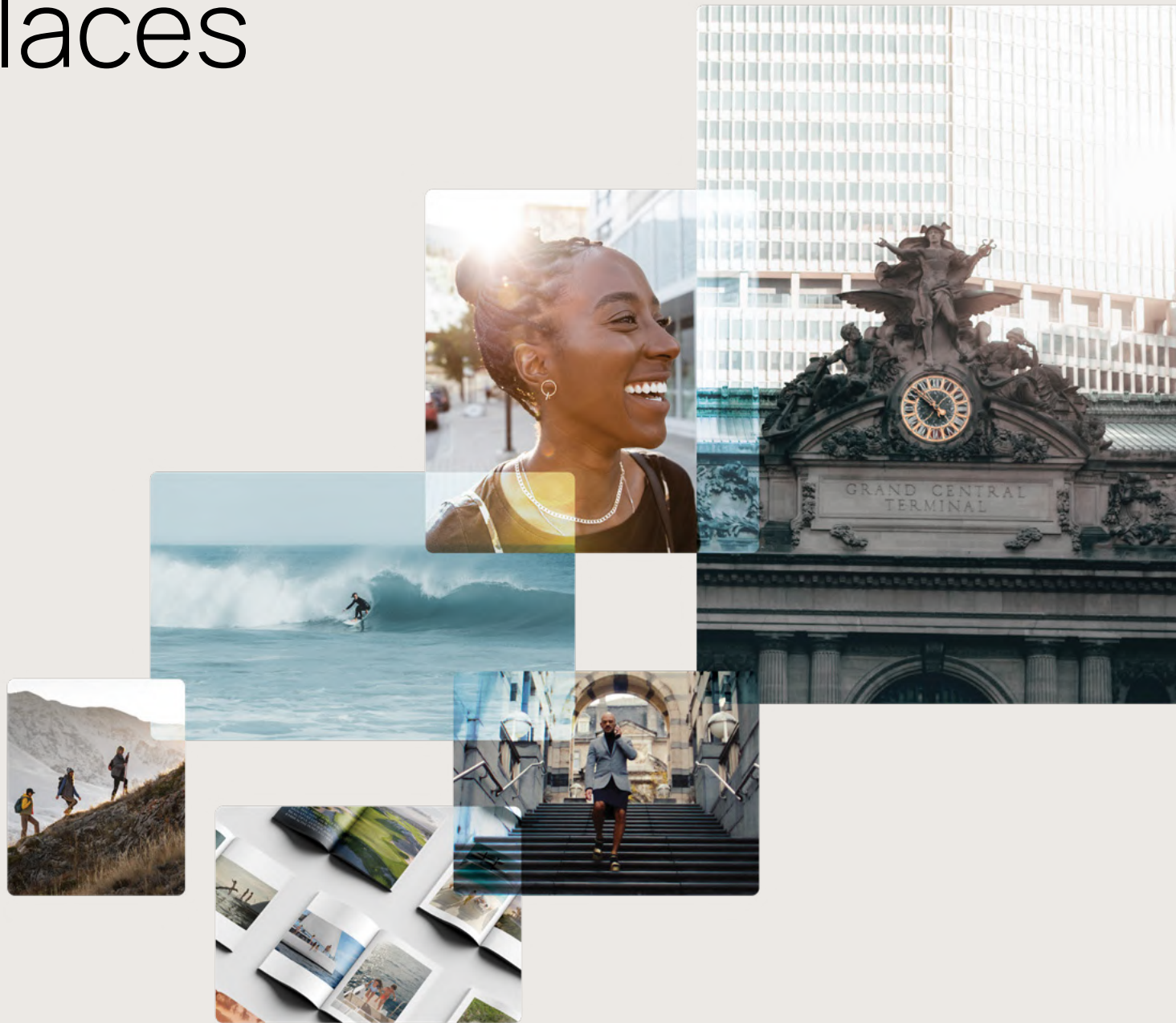
The 100 Asian and Pacific
Cities Shaping Tomorrow

2025

Asia Pacific's Best Cities



Empowering Places



Resonance creates transformative strategies, brands and campaigns that empower destinations, cities and communities to realize their full potential.

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Welcome to the 2025 Asia-Pacific's Best Cities Report

As leading advisers in place strategy, place branding and place marketing, Resonance has conducted extensive research on the rise of cities, the key trends propelling their growth and the factors that shape our perception of urban areas as desirable places to live, visit, or launch and grow a business.



Chris Fair

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It is with great excitement that we present the inaugural Asia-Pacific Best Cities Report. This initiative celebrates the extraordinary places across this dynamic region that inspire us to live, work, visit, and invest. As the fastest-growing economic zone globally, the Asia-Pacific region is home to cities that epitomize ambition, innovation, and resilience. From bustling financial hubs to serene cultural capitals, this report captures the region's urban evolution with a depth and nuance befitting its diversity.

This year, our rankings blend rigorous data with the perspectives of residents, visitors, and businesses. This approach, which we call the Place Power™ Score, evaluates cities through a comprehensive lens of perception and performance. We surveyed more than 7,000 citizens across nine countries in the region to understand the towns and cities where they would most like to live, that they would most like to visit, and where they believe they will find the best job opportunities. We combine these insights with metrics like GDP growth, foreign direct investment, infrastructure advancements, and livability improvements. The result is a data-rich narrative that benchmarks how cities in the Asia-Pacific region are shaping their futures.

In a region that represents almost 30% of global economic output and some of the world's most ambitious urban projects, this report showcases the leaders driving this growth. Cities like Tokyo and Sydney demonstrate a unique ability to balance prosperity with liveability, while emerging hubs like Bangalore and Ho Chi Minh City underscore the transformative potential of technology, innovation, and bold urban planning.

The timing of this report is pivotal. The Asia-Pacific region is not only recovering from the global pandemic but also redefining what a city can offer its residents and visitors.

New transportation projects like Bangkok's high-speed rail network and eco-conscious developments such as Singapore's Great Southern Waterfront highlight the innovative solutions cities are implementing to address urban challenges. Meanwhile, global giants such as Google, Tesla, and Samsung are doubling down on their investments in cities like Hyderabad, Seoul, and Jakarta, reshaping these metropolises into global centers of excellence.

Beyond the data, this report celebrates the intangible qualities that make cities remarkable—the festivals that enliven streets, the culinary scenes that entice travelers, and the public spaces that bring communities together. It's these elements that ensure cities resonate not only as economic powerhouses but as places where people forge lasting connections.

Our goal, for more than a decade now, is to provide a trusted resource that informs city leaders, urban planners, investors, and travelers alike. Whether you're exploring where to establish your next business venture, planning your travels, or benchmarking your city's progress, this report offers a clear, actionable perspective on what makes cities thrive.

We invite you to explore the 2025 Asia-Pacific Best Cities Report and discover the narratives driving the region's urban renaissance. Thank you for joining us on this journey of understanding and celebrating the cities that shape the future of our world.

And if you're curious about our ranking or want to benchmark your own city against your competitors, please connect with us to apply the trusted Best Cities Place Power™ score to empower your own community, city or region.

Ranking a Region Poised for Global Growth

Welcome to the inaugural Asia-Pacific's Best Cities ranking, focused on the evaluation of perception and performance for urban economies in the Asia-Pacific region.



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Asia-Pacific cities have seen immense growth in tourism spending over the past few years as travel in the region continues to rebound from the Covid-19 pandemic. Cities like Bangkok and Hong Kong have seen significant increases in global tourism spending since 2023, and the overall region is seeing strong growth. According to the World Travel and Tourism Council, seven of the top 10 cities with the highest growth potential for international visitor spending between now and 2032 are in the Asia-Pacific region.

In preparation for this inaugural Asia-Pacific's Best Cities report in partnership with Resonance, Ipsos conducted a survey of over 7,000 citizens across nine countries in the region to understand the towns and cities where they would most like to live, that they would most like to visit, and where they believe they will find the best job opportunities. This was accomplished with three open-ended questions where respondents could identify the towns and cities that they prefer:

1. Thinking about places across the Asia-Pacific region, including small towns and large cities, what are the top 3 towns or cities you would most like to live in some day?
2. Thinking about places across the Asia-Pacific region, including small towns and large cities, what are the top 3 towns or cities you would most like to visit in the next 12-24 months?
3. Thinking about places across the Asia-Pacific region, including small towns and large cities, what 3 towns or cities do you believe currently offer the best job opportunities?

The resulting data reflects the appeal of cities across the region, with significant variance in the places where people want to live or visit based on where they currently reside. Large cities are most frequently cited as the places that people want to live in and visit, and where they believe the best job opportunities are offered, but there is a wide variety of smaller destinations across Asia-Pacific also mentioned by respondents. The data shows that residents have a clear preference for locations within their own countries as places where they'd like to live. However, this preference is not as universally evident across the various countries where this research was conducted when it comes to the places that people would like to visit or that they believe offer the greatest job opportunities.

This data can be explored in a variety of ways to understand whether respondents in certain countries see destinations as offering more opportunity for work or as being more appealing to live in or visit. The data can also be evaluated using specific demographic variables, such as age, educational attainment or household income, to identify potential opportunities for your market.

We welcome the opportunity to discuss the results in greater detail and to understand how your destination performs with regard to perception and performance. Please don't hesitate to reach out to connect and discuss how Ipsos can help you better understand your target stakeholder audiences and their expectations of your place.

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Our Methodology

How we ranked Asia-Pacific's Best Cities for 2025

To rank the performance and perception of Asia-Pacific's Best Cities for 2025, Resonance analyzed the principal cities of metropolitan statistical areas with populations of more than 1,000,000 (according to Demographia, our population source). We determined the Top 100 cities using a combination of core statistics and user-generated data from online sources such as Google, Tripadvisor and Instagram to measure quality of place when it comes to experiential factors.

This blend of data led to the creation of Resonance's proprietary Place Power™ Score, the foundation of all of our Best Cities rankings. So how does Resonance choose the metrics to effectively measure an urban region's performance relative to its competitors? While many factors shape our perception of urban regions as desirable places to live, work or visit, Resonance's proprietary Place Power™ Score rankings are focused on the shared factors that demonstrate moderate to strong correlations with the performance of urban regions when it comes to attracting prime age population (age 25–44), visitor expenditure and/or business formation.

Based on our ongoing analysis, these factors are an eclectic mix that ranges from the number of Fortune 500 (Global) companies and ease of airport connectivity to the number of nightlife and outdoor recreation experiences and the volume of check-ins on Facebook and mentions on Instagram. Since these factors can change and evolve over time, we're continually updating our methodology to reflect these shifts. Case in point: we've included factors like "Price-to-Income Ratio" (to track affordability) and Healthcare System Index (to measure a city's concern for the well-being of residents) to this year's inaugural Asia-Pacific index.

We also removed inputs like Weather and Safety to more accurately represent the latest verified drivers of talent, investment and tourism to a city. As part of our new partnership with Ipsos (see page 2) we combined the performance data of the subcategories that comprise our overall Livability, Lovability and Prosperity indices with perception data reflecting the opinions and preferences of 7,006 respondents across nine Asia-Pacific countries (Australia, China, India, Indonesia, Japan, Malaysia, Singapore,

South Korea and Thailand). Each country was given equal weight in the total data set. The survey was constructed to extract the towns and cities where these 7,006 people would most like to live, where they would most like to visit, and where they believe they would find the best job opportunities. This was accomplished with three open-ended questions where respondents could identify the towns and cities that they prefer.

We asked them, when thinking about places across the globe, including small towns and large cities: which three towns or cities would you most like to live in, most like to visit and think currently offer the best job opportunities?

This open-ended question methodology enabled us to capture the destinations that are top-of-mind to survey participants rather than restricting them to a predetermined list of cities. The responses to these questions were aggregated and coded to benchmark the perception equivalent of our performance results, creating a true balance across our three overall indices of Lovability, Livability and Prosperity.

Livability

Our most layered overarching category quantifies a city's physical sense of place.

To score a city within our Livability category, we evaluate the perceived quality of its natural and built environments. This includes how much of an urban area is dedicated to green space, how susceptible it is to extreme heat and how many quality parks, sights, neighborhoods and landmarks are recommended online by locals and visitors. We also look at key socioeconomic factors such as the affordability of monthly rents and the cost of living—factors that not only retain talent, but also attract it (and, by extension, attract skill-seeking companies as well). Livability also looks at the natural attributes of a region such as the amount of tree cover and the quality of the air residents and visitors breathe.

LIVABILITY METRICS

Sights & Landmarks

The number of sights and landmarks rated above four stars, as listed on Tripadvisor (Tripadvisor.com)

Price-to-Income Ratio

The affordability of housing by way of a ratio of median apartment prices to the median family's disposable income, showing how many years of income would be needed to buy an apartment. The ratio is lower when apartments are more affordable. This ratio is calculated using a net disposable family income, estimated at 1.5 times the average net salary (based on an assumption that 50% of the workforce are women), a standard apartment size of 969 square feet, and the average price per square foot in both cities and suburban areas. (Numbeo)

Rent

The typical cost of renting a one-bedroom apartment in a city center. (Numbeo)

Air Quality

The Air Quality Index (AQI) is a measure of air pollutant concentrations in ambient air and their associated health risks. As the AQI increases, this denotes a higher level of air pollution and, as such, a higher percentage of the population is likely to experience adverse health effects in the area. The air quality index ranges from 0 to 500. Good air quality ranges from 0 to 50, while measurements over 300 are considered hazardous. (IQAir)

Healthcare System Index

The perceived quality of healthcare systems by evaluating factors like healthcare professionals, equipment and costs. Data is sourced from website visitor surveys that scored the quality of a healthcare system from -2 (strongly negative) to +2 (strongly positive). Each city's score is presented on a 0 to 100 scale. (Numbeo)

Tree Cover

This indicator measures the share of an urban area's land that is covered with vegetation that is at least 16 feet in height and with canopy cover that is greater than 50%. (OECD)

Nature & Parks

This indicator measures the number of natural areas, parks and outdoor activities rated above four stars, as listed on Tripadvisor. (Tripadvisor.com)

Heat Stress

On average, the number of days in a year that residents are exposed to extreme heat of over 90° Fahrenheit. (OECD)

Perception

Ranking in a survey of 7,006 Asia-Pacific survey respondents from nine countries about the top three cities and towns that they would most like to live in someday. (Ipsos)

Lovability

Lovability speaks to the relative vibrancy and quality of place of a city relative to its competitive set.

For almost a decade, Resonance research has shown that the more vibrant a city or region is in terms of its culture, dining and nightlife, the more visitors, young professionals and large corporations it attracts. A region's lovability also inspires residents, businesses and visitors to promote a region to the world more effectively and cost-efficiently than destination marketers can ever hope to. Resonance ranks a city's performance in each of these areas based on the number of stories, references and recommendations shared online about that city in key user-generated digital channels like Tripadvisor, Instagram and Facebook, and sought out on Google.

LOVABILITY METRICS

Nightlife

The number of local nightlife experiences rated above four stars, as listed on Tripadvisor, including bars, pubs and clubs. (Tripadvisor.com)

Shopping

The number of local shopping experiences rated above four stars, as listed on Tripadvisor, including shopping malls, farmers markets, department stores, airport shops and factory outlets in an area. (Tripadvisor.com)

Facebook Check-ins

The total number of check-ins posted by residents and tourists in a region. (Facebook.com)

Tripadvisor Reviews

The total number of reviews a destination has on Tripadvisor. (Tripadvisor.com)

Instagram Hashtags

The total number of posts with hashtags that include the name of a region. (Instagram.com)

Google Trends

Popularity on Google Trends in the past 12 months, relative to the other cities analyzed, choosing the larger total of the city (for example, "Sydney") or the city and region ("Sydney, Australia"). (Trends.Google.com)

Museums

The number of museums rated above four stars, as listed on Tripadvisor. (Tripadvisor.com)

Perception

Ranking in a survey of 7,006 Asia-Pacific survey respondents from nine countries about the top three cities and towns that they would most like to visit in the next 12 to 24 months. (Ipsos)



Sydney Harbour Bridge

Prosperity

Human capital is becoming a region's most valuable resource when it comes to generating wealth and prosperity, and, for many cities, it is increasingly in short supply.

To evaluate the relative strength of human capital from one region to the next, Resonance not only measures the number of Fortune Global 500 companies headquartered in the city, the level of the city's population and the percentage of people participating in the labor force, but also the support a city provides for start-ups and how the innovation ecosystem is distributed across each city. Wealth and prosperity are also evaluated by core statistics like business infrastructure, such as the region's airport connectivity to other destinations, and the presence and size of the convention center and its ability to welcome global investment events.

PROSPERITY METRICS

Labor Force Participation

A city's active workforce, defined as the percentage of all people of working age who are employed or are actively seeking work. (Various: OECD, World Bank, national statistics offices)

Fortune 500

The number of companies in a city that are ranked on the Fortune Global 500 list. (Fortune.com/Global500)

Airport Connectivity

The number of direct flight destinations from all commercial airports in the region. (Flightsfrom.com)

Convention Center

Size of the largest convention center in a city. (10times.com and convention center websites)

GDP per Capita

The GDP per capita in a region in U.S. dollars. (Metroverse)

Business Ecosystem

The quantity, quality and overall state of a city's business environment that contributes to the success of start-ups. (StartupBlink)

Unemployment Rate

The rate of unemployment in a region. (Various: national statistics offices)

Perception

Ranking in a survey of 7,006 Asia-Pacific survey respondents from nine countries about the top three cities and towns that they think have the best job opportunities. (Ipsos)



Shibuya Crossing, Tokyo

Asia-Pacific's Top 100 cities, in detail

The urban centers of the Asia-Pacific region are the engines of their national economies and, increasingly, the global economy. In fact, they are the pistons powering a region that accounts for a third of global economic output. For centuries, these cities have stood as symbols of human ingenuity and cultural vibrancy, shaping the narrative of progress and resilience.

In this decade of rapid transformation, Asia-Pacific cities are confronting challenges head-on, from climate resilience to equitable urban growth. The pandemic revealed foundational weaknesses in many of these metropolises, from healthcare systems to housing disparities. Yet, true to their dynamic nature, these cities are not merely recovering—they are leading the way forward, defining new paradigms of innovation, sustainability and livability.

The shifts in global talent mobility, remote work and housing affordability have fueled the rise of secondary and emerging cities across the region. From Bandung to Hyderabad, new centers of economic potential are flourishing, offering a blend of affordability, opportunity and connectivity that increasingly attracts both global talent and investment.

Government initiatives focusing on reshoring, green energy and food security have further bolstered these cities as critical nodes in the global economy.

Asia-Pacific's urban centers are more than just economic hubs—they are cultural powerhouses where people gather, create and connect. From the bustling streets of Bangkok to the tranquil innovation hubs of Singapore, these cities are redefining what it means to thrive in an interconnected world.

The 100 cities profiled in this report represent the heart of this regional renaissance. Each one, in its unique way, is helping to shape the future of the Asia-Pacific region and the global community for the rest of this decade and beyond.

1

Singapore

Singapore

PLACE POWER™ SCORE

- 1 Prosperity
- 2 Livability
- 2 Lovability

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 1 GDP per Capita
- 2 Google Trends

POPULATION

Metro 5,926,000



Jubilee Bridge

Emerging from its origins as a free-spirited trading port, Singapore has undergone a remarkable transformation to emerge as one of Asia's most modern, well-organized and captivating urban centers. With dining and shopping to match.

Two favored pastimes dominate the lives of Singapore's residents and visitors alike: shopping and eating. Ranking #4 in our ranking for Shopping, Singapore's retail landscape is a testament to the city's consumer-driven dynamism. From the glitzy malls of Orchard Road, teeming with haute couture and international brands, to the iconic 24-hour Mustafa Centre, selling everything from electronics to spices, retail is both a daily habit and an art form.

Singapore's dining scene is equally dynamic. The city's culinary diversity ranges from humble hawker centers—renowned for Michelin-starred street food—to upscale dining establishments serving dishes like spicy white pepper crab.

One of the most anticipated openings in recent years is AIR CCCC (Awareness, Impact and Responsibility Circular Campus and Cooking Club). This innovative dining experience, led by celebrated chefs Matthew Orlando and Will Goldfarb, alongside hospitality visionary Ronald Akili, has transformed a 1970s civil servant clubhouse into a glass-clad modernist venue. AIR CCCC's playful yet thought-provoking approach not only satisfies taste buds but

ignites discussions on sourcing, waste and community. A forthcoming Cooking Club and R&D lab aims to empower locals, tourists and chefs with techniques to maximize ingredient potential—a delicious education in sustainability.

Equally satisfying is feasting on the spoils of human ingenuity in which a megalopolis rose from a string of villages in well under a century. (More on that in a bit.) Start by capturing a photo from the rooftop infinity pool of Marina Bay Sands—a quintessential Singapore experience and one that is poised to grow further with plans for this premier global destination to add an additional 1,000-room hotel tower and live entertainment arena. On the opposite shore, Merlion Park offers its own iconic view, with the metallic surfboard-like head of the Merlion gazing out over the waters.

Yet, despite its towering skyscrapers and thriving financial districts, an impressive 40% of the city's land is dedicated to green spaces. This commitment to greenery is part of Singapore's Smart Nation initiative, seamlessly integrating cutting-edge technology with sustainable urban planning. Singapore's commitment to waterfront development



Gardens by the Bay

is evident in ambitious projects like the Great Southern Waterfront, which is set to transform the southern coastline. The project plans to add around 9,000 housing units and develop vibrant community spaces, bolstering Singapore's already impressive livability. Meanwhile, the forthcoming NS Square will replace the Marina Bay floating platform in 2027, bringing a multi-purpose outdoor venue to downtown.

Singapore is also exploring new modes of sustainable living, with plans for more green areas, smart urban districts and developments that promote work, education and leisure with initiatives like the pedestrian Park Connector Network enabling access to business clusters and green spaces from anywhere on the island.

Singapore reigns across our economic indicators in 2025, placing atop our overall Prosperity index and taking the top spot in our GDP per Capita subcategory.

Long lauded as one of the planet's safest cities, Singapore exemplifies a place where billionaires can stroll in flip-flops, blending casual informality with unimaginable prosperity. Dreaming big here comes naturally.

Singapore's strategic location at the tip of the Malay Peninsula, flanked by the Pacific and Indian oceans, along with its natural harbor and status as a free port, fueled its rise as a global trade hub. During World War II, the city was occupied by Japan before reverting to British control. Gaining self-governance, Singapore joined Malaysia in 1963 but was expelled due to racial tensions and political differences. Locals like to point out that the city launched in 1965, when Singapore became an independent republic. Since then, under the leadership of the People's Action Party, it has transformed into one of the world's most dynamic and prosperous cities.

The city-state's economic ascent is nothing short of astonishing. In 1965, its GDP was a modest US\$974 million; by 2023, it had surged to \$501 billion, a staggering 51,337% increase in less than six decades. This meteoric rise is underpinned by its business-friendly policies, including taxes capped at 24% and no capital gains tax, making it a magnet for investors and entrepreneurs.

Home to 64 of Asia's top 100 companies and over 200 international banks managing US\$2 trillion in assets, Singapore stands as the world's fourth-largest financial center.

The city's multicultural fabric, where 74.3% of residents are Chinese, 13.5% Malay, 9% Indian and 3.2% are other ethnicities, thrives with four official languages—English, Mandarin, Malay and Tamil—creating a rich, harmonious society that balances modernity with heritage.

The city is a key technology hub in Southeast Asia, with notable investment from global giants. Google's expansion of its cloud infrastructure and data centers in Singapore marks a US\$5-billion investment, providing services for everything from Google Search to Maps. The facility, which employs more than 500 people, underscores Singapore's growing role in Asia's digital economy. Microsoft's and Apple's parallel expansion into Southeast Asia signifies the city-state's strategic positioning as a nexus of global tech infrastructure and innovation. The expansion of Changi Aviation Park and the development of Changi East Industrial Zone promise to bolster the aviation and trade sectors. The ambitious Tuas Mega Port, slated for completion by 2040, is set to become the world's largest fully automated terminal, reinforcing Singapore's position as a global trade and logistics hub.

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Singapore city skyline

2 Tokyo Japan

PLACE POWER™ SCORE

- 1 Livability
- 1 Lovability
- 3 Prosperity

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 1 Sights & Landmarks
- 1 Nature & Parks

POPULATION

Metro 37,785,000



Mount Fuji rises above Tokyo

Despite earthquakes, tsunamis and typhoons, Tokyo has long held on to its top ranking as one of the most livable metropolises on the planet (coming in at **#2** among Asia-Pacific cities this year).

These days, Japan's capital has set its eyes on redefining the urban experience, with strategic investments in public spaces, culture and tourism. The reason? Because it can. As the economic engine of Japan—responsible for 20% of the country's GDP—Tokyo has the fourth-highest GDP per Capita in our ranking and the second-most Fortune 500 companies. No wonder the city ranks in the top three in our overall Prosperity index.

Tokyo's commitment to a sustainable, human-centered cityscape is evident in its reimagining of transportation and green spaces (it tops our ranking in the Nature & Parks subcategory). A transformative project inspired by New York City's High Line aims to repurpose a mile-long stretch of the Tokyo Expressway into a pedestrian walkway, complete with greenery, retail and recreational spaces. This initiative is part of a global shift from car-centric infrastructure to more pedestrian-friendly environments. The project will partially open by 2030, offering a new perspective on the city by allowing residents and visitors to traverse Tokyo on foot, above its kinetic streets among the skyscrapers and trains. The broader strategy to move sections of major expressways underground, including parts of the KK Line,

marks a significant shift toward enhancing walkability and reclaiming urban space for public use.

But this is also a city of craftsmanship and the art of hospitality. Having added thousands of hotel rooms over the past few years, its hotel and tourism sector is geared for resurgence, aligning with Japan's national target of attracting 60 million tourists and generating US\$136 billion in tourism revenue by 2030. The city's significant infrastructure investments, such as the expansion of Haneda Airport and a rapid 18-minute rail link to downtown by 2031, exemplify its commitment to global accessibility.

These projects reflect Tokyo's aim to balance visitor convenience with sustainable growth. The focus on smart mobility continues to reshape Tokyo's transport network and the city has begun trials of hydrogen-powered buses and electric taxis, with a target of achieving full implementation by 2030. The introduction of autonomous shuttles in the waterfront district of Odaiba marks Tokyo's commitment to futuristic, low-carbon urban mobility.

The low yen against the U.S. dollar is only helping, with global media declaring Japan as the destination of the year (whether last, this



Ueno Park

or next ranges). Conveniently, the city has also solidified its status as a global shopping destination, for which it tops our ranking. Ginza remains the center of the city's luxury offerings, with the Ginza Six center blending high-end fashion, culinary excellence and contemporary art. New luxury hotel projects, such as The Tokyo EDITION Ginza join the Four Seasons Otemachi opened in 2020, just north, reflect the city's growing appeal to high-end travelers.

In the city's west end, Miyashita Park in Shibuya enhances Tokyo's urban retail experience, offering not only boutique shopping and dining but also active spaces like volleyball courts and a skatepark. The city's ambitious Shibuya Redevelopment Project is set to complete its final phase by 2027, transforming this iconic district into a model of integrated urban living. New pedestrian bridges, rooftop gardens and eco-friendly office towers will redefine Shibuya's skyline, making it a blueprint for future city centers worldwide.

A couple miles away, the stunning new Janu hotel, the Tokyo flagship of Aman's slightly thriftier sister brand, may just be the embodiment of the city like nowhere

else, if considered minimalism and service are your barometers. The Azabudai Hills' plentiful green spaces are matched with Tokyo's largest Hermès location and the city's newest destination dining experiences. But don't worry: the gym's boxing ring lets you get it all out if reserved stoicism isn't getting it done. The district (and emerging other developments like it such as nearby Toranomon Hills) is following the path of Azabudai Hills, reshaping the cityscape and creating "vertical cities" that blend business, retail, leisure and living. And increasingly, public art, as Tokyo's new teamLab Borderless at the Azabudai Hills complex demonstrates.

Like the rest of the city, you have to experience it to believe it.

There's a higher purpose here, however. The Toranomon-Azabudai development is poised to become Tokyo's answer to Silicon Valley, with cutting-edge office spaces, incubators and collaborative zones designed to attract start-ups and multinational tech firms alike. Initiatives like the Tokyo Startup Ecosystem Consortium offer support through funding, mentorship and international networking, fostering a climate ripe for technological breakthroughs.

Meanwhile, Odaiba's Digital Innovation Zone is transforming into a nexus for AI research, robotics and VR experiences. By 2026, this district will house the Tokyo VR Park, a state-of-the-art center for virtual and augmented reality applications in fields ranging from healthcare to entertainment.

But it's not all luxury redevelopment and tech pipes in this coveted urban gem. Neighborhood initiatives like the Kanda River Revitalization Project, set to be completed in 2025, are breathing new life into forgotten waterways. Combining flood prevention with recreational spaces, the project is just one of dozens in the city that threads the needle with environmental resilience and walking paths, seating areas and interactive art installations along the riverbanks. These micro-projects contribute to Tokyo's reputation as a city that balances efficiency with environmental consciousness.

The relentless evolution here goes beyond infrastructure and public spaces; it reflects a deeply ingrained cultural ethos that values continuous improvement, or kaizen. The city's meticulous attention to detail extends to its hospitality sector, culinary scene and retail experience, blending the heritage

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of craftsmanship with a forward-thinking approach to innovation.

Tokyo has long held the crown as the city with the most Michelin-starred restaurants in the world. With over 200 Michelin-ranked establishments, the city's culinary scene is a mosaic of flavors, techniques and traditions. The addition of new stars in 2024 underscores Tokyo's unwavering commitment to gastronomic excellence. The city's cafes and patisseries are no less inventive. The recent opening of La Boutique de Joël Robuchon in Marunouchi brings French patisserie finesse to the heart of Tokyo's financial district.

The city's top spot in our Museums subcategory will only strengthen with the Yayoi Kusama Museum Expansion in Shinjuku and the opening of Sumida Hokusai Museum's new wing in 2024 that celebrates Japan's artistic legacy, offering interactive exhibits and workshops.

Meanwhile, Tokyo's Cultural Heritage Preservation Program that funds the restoration of Edo-period buildings and Shinto shrines is as strong as ever, ensuring that history remains an integral part of the urban narrative, and the city's Sights & Landmarks position stays firmly at #1 in our ranking.



Sanja Festival

3

Seoul

South Korea

PLACE POWER™ SCORE

- 3 Livability
- 5 Lovability
- 5 Prosperity

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 2 Museums
- 3 Fortune 500

POPULATION

Metro 23,225,000



Downtown Seoul skyline

Riding the Hallyu wave, Seoul has firmly established itself as a global pop culture powerhouse. Next up: widening its economic and innovation moat to maintain its growing appeal to global talent.

A thriving hub for everything “K”—from K-pop and K-dramas to innovative K-beauty, South Korea’s megalopolis capital is home to global cultural icons like BTS and renowned filming location landmarks like Gwangjang Market, frequented by Netflix foodies and Michelin-starred chefs. With 176 Michelin-rated restaurants, Seoul is perhaps the stealthiest culinary destination on the planet. Start at Mukja Golmok, literally “Let’s Eat Alley,” move on to the vegetable-centric temple cuisine at Dooreyoo, Michelin-starred chef Tony Yoo’s oasis, then head to Gwangjang Market, where you can eat everything from a soup of rice cakes and kimchi-tofu dumplings to squirmly live octopus (really).

With Seoul’s digital transformation into a high-tech metropolis with cutting-edge 5G and even 6G networks, it now boasts the third-most Fortune 500 firms (trailing only Beijing and Tokyo, respectively) as well as thousands of start-ups looking to join their ranks.

As travel rebounds, Seoul’s popularity soars; it was the fourth-most searched destination on Airbnb in 2022, and the government is capitalizing on this post-pandemic momentum by investing in its events industry, expediting three major

international conference clusters to attract global business.

Seoul’s push to remain at the forefront of global business is evident through significant infrastructure investments. The Seoul Vision 2030 Fund stands as a testament to this, channeling US\$4.22 billion into global start-up growth. The opening of the Seoul Startup Hub Scale-up Center in 2023 marked a new era for investment exchange among private investors, accelerators and burgeoning start-ups. The Seoul Unicorn Startup Hub aims to launch (or is it “birth”?) 50 unicorns by 2030 and plans to establish 10 start-up support centers globally by 2026. Further reinforcing its tech prowess, the AI Startup School, launched in collaboration with Google, equips early-stage entrepreneurs with vital resources. From bars to co-workspaces, the city’s entrepreneurialism is visceral, and the next half-decade will be filled with a pipeline of locally launched companies, from new takes on grocery delivery (Kurly) to fintech (Korea Credit Data).

Given the international commerce, the city is blooming dozens of new hotel towers, including the luxurious business-forward Grand Hyatt Seoul in the heart of Gangnam,



Cheonggyecheon Stream

and the nearby Shilla Stay Yeoksam, a new boutique property providing a blend of traditional Korean hospitality and modern amenities. You may have heard of the fast-growing Lotte hotel group—and the hotelier is ensuring it innovates locally with their new Lotte Hotel Seoul Tower near the iconic Namsan Tower, offering panoramic views and increasingly globally lauded premium services. The Four Seasons Hotel Seoul (financial district) and InterContinental Seoul (Myeongdong) will keep the other new luxury properties on their toes when they open over the next year.

But the city's fairytale ascent turned nightmarish in late 2024 with the declaration of martial law on December 3, 2024, by President Yoon Suk Yeol—allegedly due to anti-state activities and North Korean interference. Although only in effect for six hours, it sparked significant political turmoil and introduced an era of political instability, with the president's impeachment and removal in mid-December. The crisis has temporarily paralyzed South Korean politics, frozen foreign policy initiatives and disrupted financial markets. So much so, in fact, that the city's economic growth forecast has been adjusted to 2% by the Asian Development

Bank, citing the unrest as well as a forecasted semiconductor sector downturn.

Despite these challenges, Seoul has banked enough livability karma to persevere (ranking #3 in our overall Livability index).

The next few years will see the fruits of an ambitious urban design plan aimed at transforming the city into a dynamic cultural hub. The Urban Architectural Design Innovation Plan includes reforms to building regulations, the development of new facilities and a focus on architectural design. This plan aims to foster creative design in both the public and private sectors, establish a unique zoning system and streamline administrative processes to enable quicker decision-making.

The city's #2 ranking in our Museums subcategory will be strengthened over the next year or two with the planned opening of Centre Pompidou x Hanwha Museum Project Seoul within Hanwha's 63 Building in Yeouido as a collaboration with France's Centre Pompidou. Equally anticipated is the National Museum of Korean Literature in the city's north end, which will feature exhibition halls exploring the past, present and future of Korean literature when it opens in late 2026.

Seoul is introducing new green spaces and multi-purpose precincts to enhance the quality of life for its citizens (as well as its #12 ranking for Nature & Parks). A big part of this is a focus on creating a more ecologically and socially rich environment through projects like the Hyper-Abundant City concept for Apgujeong district, which aims to establish long-term plans for the city's infrastructure and introduce micro-projects that promote biodiversity on the urban surfaces of paths, terraces and façades.

The commitment is being codified in the city's urban planning as well, most notably guided by the Smart Seoul 2030 initiative, which envisions a future-ready city teeming with smart infrastructure. This includes intelligent transportation systems, smart grids and eco-friendly urban development projects. The development of new residential complexes, business districts and green belts aims to balance the city's rapid growth with sustainability goals.

Seoul's dedication to enhancing livability is also highlighted by initiatives like the Hangang Renaissance Project that will revitalize the Han River area with new parks, cultural spaces and recreational facilities. This project seeks

The city's #2 ranking in our Museums subcategory will be strengthened over the next year or two with the planned opening of Centre Pompidou x Hanwha Museum Project Seoul within Hanwha's 63 Building in Yeouido as a collaboration with France's Centre Pompidou.

to transform the riverbanks into vibrant community hubs that promote well-being and social interaction. By transforming its iconic riverbanks into bustling community hubs, Seoul aims to enhance well-being and foster social interaction. For urban adventurers, the Sky Forest Corridor is set to open by 2026, connecting the Namsan Tower area to the Cheonggyecheon Stream with an elevated pedestrian path lined with green spaces and public art installations.

Adding to its green agenda is the Hyper-Abundant City concept, which reimagines districts like Apgujeong with urban surfaces designed to support biodiversity. This project integrates micro-solutions such as green terraces, eco-paths, and urban gardens, ensuring Seoul becomes a leader in ecological urbanism.

Now if only someone had advised the government to reconsider the city's new "Seoul, My Soul" brand....



4

Hong Kong

China

PLACE POWER™ SCORE

- 4 Lovability
- 4 Livability
- 8 Prosperity

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 1 Google Trends
- 2 Nature & Parks

POPULATION

Metro 6,468,000



Hong Kong skyline from Victoria Peak

A global business destination fights to reclaim its magnetism and livability by doubling down on a long-planned cultural renaissance as China's grip tightens.

Hong Kong's dynamism has always been rooted in its remarkable diversity. In a single day, visitors can experience a fishing village just an hour from downtown, relax on a sun-drenched beach, shop in either a glittering modern mall or a timeless back-alley market, indulge in globally renowned cuisine, and finish the evening in one of the city's countless vibrant bars or cafés. Despite its political turbulence and Beijing's tightening grip, the city still radiates pride and passion, holding strong at #4 for both Lovability and Livability.

Hong Kong continues to look forward with ambitious projects that are shaping its skyline and enriching its cultural scene. One such landmark is the West Kowloon Cultural District, a 100-acre marvel of reclaimed land along Victoria Harbour, designed by Foster + Partners. After 30 years of anticipation, the district has delivered world-class museums, performance spaces and sprawling parkland, offering much-needed breathing room for this dense metropolis. The city's twin #6 rankings in our Museums and Shopping subcategories will only improve. For decades, Hong Kong's reputation as a "cultural desert" overshadowed its culinary and commercial prowess. That perception is now obsolete.

The West Kowloon Cultural District is a testament to the city's artistic evolution, anchored by venues like the Hong Kong Palace Museum, which opened in 2022. With its ingot-inspired design, the museum houses treasures from China's imperial past, including Ming dynasty ceramics and artifacts from the Forbidden City.

Nearby, the waterfront Art Park invites joggers, picnickers and museum-goers to unwind in green spaces dotted with cafés and eateries—a perfect spot for sunset views and experiencing the city's #2 ranking for Nature & Parks. Freespace, the district's versatile performance center, supports experimental theater and live music, while M+ rivals international powerhouses like MoMA with works by Ai Weiwei and an impressive design collection. The Xiqu Centre, with its shimmering fish-scale facade, champions Cantonese opera, offering an architectural respite even for those unfamiliar with the art form.

Yet challenges persist. In the Kai Tak district, once envisioned as a gleaming hub of residential luxury, falling property prices have left many homeowners with underwater mortgages.

5

Beijing China

PLACE POWER™ SCORE

- 2 Prosperity
- 12 Lovability
- 13 Livability

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 1 Fortune 500
- 1 Business Ecosystem

POPULATION

Metro 18,883,000



CCTV Headquarters

One of China's "Four Ancient Capitals," Beijing walks a fine line between progress and politics. Economically, it struts confidently as it attracts global trade and attention like never before.

Enigmatic hutongs whisper tales of emperors and concubines; next to them, towering skyscrapers reflect Beijing's rapid global ascent. A profound transformation is afoot as the megalopolis balances rapid urbanization with the weight of its 3,000-year-old history. Ranking #2 in Prosperity, second only to Singapore (including boasting the most Fortune 500 companies in our ranking), the city's #13 Livability index finish reflects the persistent pollution, congestion and pressures of 18 million residents. The government is pushing hard to address these issues, but progress remains uneven.

Major infrastructure projects are underway, with a particular focus on expanding green spaces and improving public transport. However, residents express skepticism, as air quality remains an ongoing concern despite government initiatives. The recent expansion of Beijing's high-speed rail network, connecting it to key cities across China, promises to ease some transport woes, but the sheer scale of urban sprawl means challenges remain. Beijing Daxing International Airport (ranked #2), a key pillar of China's global connectivity strategy, continues to grow, although

there's increasing tension over the city's hospitality sector. New luxury hotels and high-end serviced apartments are sprouting up, targeting international business travelers and tourists, yet many locals are feeling the pinch as real estate prices soar, driven in part by foreign investment. Nevertheless, the newly opened Mandarin Oriental Wangfujing and other upcoming properties bring world-class service to Beijing's heart, catering to discerning international visitors and business travelers. Meanwhile, the city's #16-ranked nightlife scene thrives with hotspots like Zhaolong Rooftop Bar, offering panoramic views of the illuminated skyline.

Beijing's urban evolution continues with a slate of ambitious projects designed to balance modernity with tradition. The city recently unveiled the Tongzhou Grand Canal Park, a nearly eight-square-mile expanse blending history and recreation, offering walking paths, cultural exhibitions and waterfront spaces that pay homage to the ancient waterway. Complementing this is the recently opened Beijing Sub-Center Library, a futuristic architectural marvel that merges cutting-edge design with the city's rich literary heritage.

6

Bangkok

Thailand

PLACE POWER™ SCORE

- 3** Lovability
- 14** Livability
- 13** Prosperity

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 1** Facebook Check-ins
- 1** Tripadvisor Reviews

POPULATION

Metro 6,468,000



Wat Paknam Phasi Charoen

From stag-party hot spot to Russian haven, Thailand's capital has flipped the script on its global perception.

Everything most of us know about Bangkok has to do with exotic food, illicit massage parlors, beautiful beaches or thrift shopping. Parodied in cringy films and unjustly reduced to stereotypes, Asia's "City of Angels" is a unique metropolis where spirituality and hedonism coexist. Today, every corner of this city is abuzz with activity—thanks to a surge in visitors from Russia taking advantage of no sanctions and easy passage as they escape conscription to Ukraine's killing fields and Russia's general self-inflicted misery. All this activity is set amidst Thailand's own volatile political scene, with crippling street demonstrations last year after Pita Limjaroenrat was barred from running for prime minister. That hasn't stopped the city from rising up the ranks, with a Top 3 position in our overall Lovability index thanks to its #1 rankings for both Facebook Check-ins and Tripadvisor Reviews (to say nothing of its #2 spots in both Nightlife and Shopping). Bangkok's nightlife remains electrifying, with rooftop bars such as The Penthouse Bar + Grill at Park Hyatt and new speakeasies and other after-dark concepts continuing to redefine the city's serpentine nocturnal experience. More than 40 hotels are scheduled to open across the capital by 2027.

The city's investment in high-speed rail connectivity will transform it into a hub of Southeast Asia's transport network by 2028, making the sweet sensory overload that is Bangkok more accessible than ever. Additionally, the Suvarnabhumi Airport Expansion—set for completion in 2026—will increase annual passenger capacity by 30 million, making the city more connected and accessible than ever.

Bangkok's urban building momentum shows no signs of slowing, as ambitious development and hospitality projects reshape the city's landscape. The recent unveiling of the Bangkok Central Park—a sprawling 60-acre green oasis in the heart of the city—reflects a commitment to livability and sustainability, offering cycling paths, a lake and spaces for public art installations. Watch for the city's #20 Nature & Parks subcategory to improve as a result. Alongside this, the Benjakitti Forest Park Expansion, completed in 2024, has transformed an old tobacco factory site into a lush, biodiverse sanctuary for city-dwellers craving respite from the traffic: both motorized and human.

7

Sydney

Australia

PLACE POWER™ SCORE

- 5 Livability
- 7 Lovability
- 9 Prosperity

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 2 Air Quality
- 5 Google Trends

POPULATION

Metro 4,836,000



Sydney Harbour Bridge

Sydneysiders have a lot to be proud of—and even more to share with the world.

Sydney unveils a dazzling narrative punctuated by the luminous Opera House, the iconic Harbour Bridge—colloquially known as the “coat hanger”—and sun-drenched beaches, from Bondi to Balmoral and beyond. Here, long, laidback summers melt into mild, mellow winters amidst our rankings’ second-best Air Quality—the perfect backdrop to explore Sydney’s remarkable blend of vintage and modern, from the colonial-era sandstone buildings of The Rocks to new icons like the Sydney Tower. Today’s Sydney finds itself at a pivotal juncture that looks to infuse renewed vitality into the central business district (CBD) and improve the greater city’s impressive #5 ranking in our overall Livability index (to say nothing of its #7 Lovability spot).

The CBD, once a primarily commercial area, is now a vibrant mixed-use district showcasing Sydney’s drive to balance economic growth with cultural inclusivity. New tram lines and an expanded harbor have made the area more walkable, while green plazas and waterfront promenades breathe life into previously underused spaces.

Sydney’s cultural heartbeat has also grown stronger, with the Art Gallery of New South Wales nearly doubling its exhibition space

through a new glass structure designed by Japanese architects SANAA. The museum focuses on works by Aboriginal and women artists, signaling a commitment to Indigenous heritage and diverse storytelling. Aptly named Naala Badu, meaning “seeing waters” in the language of the Dharug people, the gallery reflects Sydney’s push for cultural recognition and community engagement. Watch the city’s #9 Museum ranking ascend in short order. Sydney’s “24-Hour Economy Strategy” underpins the resurgence of its nightlife, dining and cultural scenes. Initiatives like permanent al fresco dining licenses have transformed city streets, and events like the Laneway Festival have successfully lured people back into the urban core.

Sydney’s #9 ranking in our overall Prosperity index indicates its status as an economic powerhouse. The city is actively encouraging growth in tech and innovation through projects like Tech Central, a sprawling urban renewal initiative that aims to foster an ecosystem of start-ups, universities and investors right in the city’s center.

8

Shanghai

China

PLACE POWER™ SCORE

- 4** Prosperity
- 11** Lovability
- 28** Livability

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 1** Airport Connectivity
- 2** Business Ecosystem

POPULATION

Metro 24,042,000



The Bund

China's current commercial nucleus is home to 113 billionaires—and has ambitions for more.

Within the dynamic metropolis of Shanghai, contrasts unfold. On one side of the Huangpu River lies the refined Puxi district, housing the city's Art Deco architectural marvels, the waterfront Bund promenade and traditional Chinese gardens. On the opposite side, the Pudong area showcases its mind-boggling, otherworldly skyscrapers. Shanghai today is a major global hub for everything from finance, business, research, technology and manufacturing to arts and culture.

It's also home to the world's busiest container port. Challenges abound, from air pollution and impoverished slums to a growing vulnerability to rising sea levels. Nevertheless, the city scores high in our overall Prosperity index (#4), with the second-highest number of billionaire residents on the planet, at 113, helping the cause. To say nothing of its #2 ranking in our Business Ecosystem subcategory and #4 for Fortune 500 companies. The "Shanghai 2035" plan, approved by state council, envisions a metropolis characterized by innovation, humanity, sustainability and global influence—effectively putting the city on a rising path by focusing on onboarding more citizens into the ever-sprouting skyscrapers they look up at daily (at least when the smog clears).

A host of initiatives shaping the city's skyline and cultural fabric include the North Bund Development Project, set for completion in 2025, that aims to rival the city's gilded Lujiazui district with 90 million square feet of office, retail and residential space, further solidifying Shanghai's status as a global financial hub. Meanwhile, the Xuhui Riverside Green Space, completed in early 2024, offers a sprawling four-mile waterfront park replete with walking paths, art installations and performance venues, providing a lush escape in the heart of the city. The city's #13 Nature & Parks ranking and a Tree Cover spot well outside our Top 100 needs all the green space it can get.

Luxury hospitality is also thriving. The recently opened Janu Shanghai and Bulgari Hotel Shanghai fuse opulent design with contemporary amenities, catering to high-end travelers and business elites. The Longhua Temple Night Market, launched in 2024, revives historic traditions with modern flair. Meanwhile, upgrades to the #1-ranked Pudong International Airport—including a new satellite terminal by 2026—promise to enhance connectivity and efficiency, reinforcing Shanghai's position as a nexus of global commerce and culture.

9

Melbourne

Australia

PLACE POWER™ SCORE

- 6** Livability
- 9** Lovability
- 14** Prosperity

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 3** Sights & Landmarks
- 4** Heat Stress

POPULATION

Metro 4,709,000



Melbourne downtown skyline

Street art and scenic trails are just the tip of the ice coffee for Australia's second-largest city, which is increasingly ascending as an economic regional power.

Melbourne may not have centuries-old landmarks (although it did finish an impressive #3 in our Sights & Landmarks subcategory), but it more than makes up for it with its vibrant food, coffee culture and arts scene. Graffitied laneways like Hosier Lane, quirky attractions such as the Brighton Bathing Boxes and the adorable St. Kilda penguins all add to the city's charm. As a gateway to 21 wine regions, including the Yarra Valley and Mornington Peninsula, Melbourne truly epitomizes "wine country." The city's annual Australian Open, the first Grand Slam to attract over a million fans in 2024, is a global sports highlight adding to the city's #9 Lovability index score, a reflection of its appeal to both locals and visitors.

To address the challenges of population growth in what's increasingly perceived as a balanced, safe and resilient global hometown, the city is undertaking transformative urban projects under Plan Melbourne 2017-2050. Key initiatives include the Metro Tunnel, which will enhance public transport capacity when it opens in 2025, and the revitalization of Federation Square with enhanced pedestrian access and green spaces. Hospitality developments are equally ambitious. The recently opened Ritz-Carlton Melbourne is elevating luxury accommodation, while

the expansion of the Queen Victoria Market precinct is reshaping the skyline.

Melbourne's reputation as a dynamic, future-ready city is further cemented by ambitious new initiatives shaping its skyline, culture and livability. The Greenline Project, a transformative US\$300-million urban renewal plan, is set to revitalize the Yarra River's north bank by 2026, creating five interconnected waterfront precincts featuring walking trails, green spaces and public art, and soon to enhance Melbourne's already impressive Top 10 Nature & Parks ranking.

The city is also ascendant economically, with the Arden Precinct Development, scheduled for completion by 2025, aiming to transform North Melbourne into a thriving innovation hub, home to research facilities, start-ups and health tech enterprises. Meanwhile, the Docklands revitalization continues, with the addition of new residential towers, office spaces and dining venues. At Melbourne Airport (ranked #44), a US\$1-billion expansion project is underway, including a third runway and upgraded international terminal, set to bolster the city's connectivity by 2026 and ensure Melbourne remains not just Australia's cultural capital but a globally coveted place to call home, too.

10

Kuala Lumpur Malaysia

PLACE POWER™ SCORE

- 11** Livability
- 12** Prosperity
- 14** Lovability

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 4** Labor Force Participation
- 6** Tree Cover

POPULATION

Metro 9,387,000



Patronas Twin Towers

Deep traditions and fearless innovation weave a dense tapestry in Malaysia's buzzing capital. You'll be hearing a lot more about the city known as "KL".

Kuala Lumpur perfectly blends tradition with modern innovation, creating one of the most dynamic cities in the Asia-Pacific region. Ranking #4 in our Labor Force Participation subcategory and #12 in our overall Prosperity index, KL's economy thrives on its booming financial and tech sectors, which continue to attract global talent. Major commercial hubs such as KL Sentral and Bangsar South showcase the city's growth, housing numerous multinational corporations and start-ups. The city made global news in 2024 with the opening of the second-tallest building in the world after the Burj Khalifa in Dubai. The 118-story Merdeka 118 Tower boasts luxury accommodations and an observation deck offering breathtaking views of the city. KL is also a multiculturalism dynamo, and the city's rich mix of Malay, Chinese and Indian influences serve up a vibrant food scene, with street food like nasi lemak and char kway teow coexisting alongside world-class dining options. This diversity extends to the city's thriving hospitality sector, with the opening in 2022 of the Bukit Bintang City Centre—a sprawling mixed-use development featuring high-end retail, hotels and entertainment venues—and the Park Hyatt Kuala Lumpur in 2025.

Kuala Lumpur's visionary urban development and strategic investments continue to blend luxury, culture and innovation. The city is enhancing its green infrastructure with the River of Life project, an ambitious effort to clean and revitalize the Klang and Gombak rivers. Slated for completion in 2026, this initiative will create pedestrian-friendly walkways, lush riverside parks and cultural hubs, transforming once-neglected areas into vibrant public spaces. With an already impressive #6 Tree Cover ranking, this verdant city continues to go all in on its natural attributes. Meanwhile, the Saloma Link Bridge, connecting Kampung Baru to the city center, has quickly become an iconic night-time attraction with its illuminated, futuristic design.

In hospitality, the Park Hyatt Kuala Lumpur, opening in 2025 within the Merdeka 118 Tower, promises to redefine luxury with unparalleled views and opulent amenities. Additionally, the Fairmont Kuala Lumpur, set to open in 2026, will offer refined accommodations and add to the city's growing portfolio of five-star hotels. These developments complement the ongoing expansion of Kuala Lumpur International Airport (already ranking an impressive #14), which aims to boost passenger capacity and streamline travel with cutting-edge technology by 2025.



11 Osaka Japan

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 4 Nightlife
- 5 Tree Cover

POPULATION

Metro 14,916,000

From street-eats to side-splitting laughter, Osaka serves up a menu of delights.

Japan's third-largest city and an economic engine, Osaka has a long history of feeding its millions of inhabitants well, earning the city its motto: kuidaore, or "eat till you drop." Affectionately known as tenka no daidokoro—the country's kitchen—Osaka is Japan's street food capital, home of takoyaki and okonomiyaki (as well as the birthplace of the infamous sushi conveyor belt). But the city also tickles many a funny bone with an abundance of comedy clubs specializing in manzai, a sillier take on the "straight man and wacky guy" comedy routine. A direct result of that beloved foodie culture and those must-see experiences is a decent showing in our Livability and Lovability indices, at #7 and #13 respectively—numbers that are poised to rise in the coming years. And, recently, the government cemented Osaka's place as a hub of entertainment by approving a controversial plan for the country's first casino. To be built on the city's artificial island of Yumeshima, it will be part of a US\$12.8-billion resort due to be completed in 2029. The annual Tourism EXPO Japan Osaka Kansai, which attracts 150,000 visitors annually, lets the city stay top of mind while captivating the imagination of travelers through a kaleidoscope of sensory and savory experiences.



12 Delhi India

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 3 Google Trends
- 3 Facebook Check-ins

POPULATION

Metro 31,190,000

The Indian capital wants to own the future.

India's sprawling capital is steeped in history yet rapidly modernizing. The balance is illustrated by Delhi's #8 ranking for Lovability, with impressive finishes in the Google Trends, Facebook Check-ins and Instagram Hashtags subcategories, as well as its Top 10 finish in our overall Prosperity index. The latter has been fueled of late by significant infrastructure projects, including the Delhi-Mumbai Expressway and the development of Noida International Airport. These initiatives have driven a 20%-plus rise in per capita income in 2024, further cementing Delhi's status as a growing business hub. In addition, Delhi is also seeing the construction of large-scale commercial and residential developments in regions like Dwarka and Gurugram, which are drawing significant investment from both domestic and international firms. With a Gross State Domestic Product of US\$135 billion (yet still a long way to go considering its #64 spot in our GDP per Capita subcategory), Delhi plays a crucial role in India's economic surge. Global tech companies like Google and Amazon have established operations in the city, contributing to its vibrant business ecosystem (#4 in our ranking), alongside local unicorns like Zomato and Oyo. The city's expanding metro network and urban development initiatives, such as green spaces in Lodhi Gardens and bike-sharing programs, should boost Delhi's current #54 Livability ranking.



13 Mumbai India

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 1 Instagram Hashtags
- 2 Facebook Check-ins

POPULATION

Metro 25,189,000

Glamour and grit rise to a deafening crescendo in India's financial heart.

Known for its glitzy Bollywood film industry and towering skyscrapers, Mumbai also houses some of the world's largest slums—a juxtaposition emblematic of its identity. The city ranks Top 10 in our rankings for both Business Ecosystem (#8) and the number of Fortune 500 companies (#9), underlining its role as India's economic engine. The Mumbai International Financial Centre, set for completion by 2030, will elevate the city's standing as a global financial hub, introducing new skyscrapers, state-of-the-art office spaces and cutting-edge digital infrastructure. Mumbai also shines culturally, ranking 13th for Sights & Landmarks. The Taj Mahal Palace, Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Terminus and Gateway of India are enduring symbols of its colonial heritage and architectural grandeur.

Innovative spaces like the Museum of Solutions in Lower Parel embody Mumbai's commitment to the future. This 100,000-square-foot children's museum blends STEAM education with hands-on, real-world problem-solving, preparing the next generation of changemakers. As infrastructure projects like the new Navi Mumbai International Airport (scheduled to open in late 2025) and the Mumbai-Ahmedabad Bullet Train (slated for 2027) improve connectivity, Mumbai's relentless ambition ensures it will continue to inspire and astonish.



14 Bangalore India

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 3 Business Ecosystem
- 6 Google Trends

POPULATION

Metro 15,257,000

India's tech powerhouse and vibrant cultural melting pot plays as hard as it works.

Bangalore, often called the Silicon Valley of India, is a city that masterfully blends cutting-edge technology with a deep-rooted cultural heritage. Ranking #11 in our Prosperity pillar (fueled by a Top 3 ranking in our Business Ecosystem subcategory), Bangalore's economy is driven by its booming IT sector, which houses major players like Infosys, Wipro and IBM. The city is also a hub for start-ups, with companies like Swiggy and Byju's making Bangalore one of India's most dynamic business environments. The influx of investments, including major commitments from companies such as Wistron and Air India, has its GDP growth rate projected to grow by almost 10% annually through 2025. But Bangalore plays as hard as it works, ranking #15 in our overall Lovability index, driven by its #6 spots for both Google Trends and Facebook Check-ins. There's plenty to explore across this pulsing urbanity, and plentiful green spaces such as Cubbon Park and Lalbagh Botanical Garden that offer residents and visitors a refreshing escape from the city's fast-paced lifestyle. Recent initiatives like the development of eco-friendly infrastructure and expansions to public parks will improve the city's middling #82 spot for Tree Cover and downright alarming #130 ranking for Air Quality.



15 Auckland New Zealand

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 1 Air Quality
- 2 Heat Stress

POPULATION

Metro 1,537,000

Coast-to-coast distilled urbanism in a naturally endowed context.

New Zealand's largest and most cosmopolitan city balances modernity with natural beauty (and the best metro air quality in our ranking). Known for its iconic twin harbors and dormant volcanoes, the city also ranks #2 in our Heat Stress subcategory. Recent developments have transformed its skyline and urban core, with Commercial Bay leading the way. This mixed-use precinct has revolutionized the Central Business District's retail and hospitality landscape, adding luxury boutiques and elevated dining to the heart of the city. The revitalized Viaduct Harbour is also a focal point, boasting new high-end hotels that cater to both tourists and business travelers. Britomart, once an industrial zone, has undergone a two-decade-long transformation into a vibrant, modern precinct, blending heritage buildings with cutting-edge architecture. The City Rail Link, expected to be completed in 2026, will dramatically improve transit connectivity across the city, easing congestion and fostering economic growth. The Auckland waterfront is also undergoing enhancements to support the America's Cup, which promises to boost tourism and investment in the city. As a result, Tāmaki Makaurau (Auckland's Māori name, meaning "the place desired by many") is bulging at the seams, and is projected to host nearly half of New Zealand's current population by 2048. It seems the secret on its Top 10 spot in our overall Livability index is out.



16 Taipei Taiwan

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 5 Shopping
- 6 Healthcare System Index

POPULATION

Metro 9,662,000

A balanced landscape of future-defining tech manufacturing and its coveted good life.

Taipei's blend of innovation, culture and natural beauty is best unwrapped slowly, like the bamboo leaves from a Zongzi savory rice dumpling that is served everywhere here. The city checks all the boxes equally across our three pillars: #12 in our overall Livability pillar, #18 for Lovability and #46 for Prosperity. Its quality of life is easy to experience, from a stealthily booming dining scene ranging from Michelin-starred soup dumplings at Din Tai Fung to boba tea, which was invented in Taipei, to the sixth-best Healthcare System. The city's plentiful parks (ranked #8) sate residents between visits to Yangmingshan National Park just a short drive away. Taipei is also a global tech hub, home to companies like Acer and Asus, driving its #9 ranking in our Fortune 500 subcategory, and boasts a #16 spot for Business Ecosystem. All that homegrown innovation helps the city rank in the Top 5 for Shopping, where tech gadgets and cultural treasures coexist. New developments such as Taipei Sky Tower further enhance the city's retail appeal, providing luxury experiences for both tourists and locals. The city's progressive social policies, including being the first in Asia to legalize same-sex marriage, make it an inclusive and welcoming environment for residents and visitors alike.



17 Guangzhou China

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 1 Convention Center
- 4 Airport Connectivity

POPULATION

Metro 27,119,000

Where culinary excellence and global trade converge in a city of opportunity.

Guangzhou is a city where culinary brilliance and global commerce intersect, creating a dynamic and multifaceted urban experience. As the birthplace of Cantonese cuisine, Guangzhou ranks among the top food cities in the world, offering culinary delights from dim sum to roasted meats. The phrase “To eat is to be in Guangzhou” speaks volumes about the city’s reputation. The dining is matched by Guangzhou’s prominence in international trade, where it ranks #6 in our overall Prosperity index. The city is home to the Canton Fair, China’s largest and longest-running import-export event, which attracts business leaders and buyers from around the world. Its economic strength is further supported by Guangzhou Baiyun International Airport, which ranks #4 in our Airport subcategory, making it a key gateway for international trade and tourism. In 2023, Guangzhou attracted US\$6.8 billion in foreign investment, a foreign capital surge that has driven the establishment of thousands of new foreign-invested enterprises, further solidifying the city’s role as a global business hub. No wonder its Convention Center tops our ranking. Guangzhou’s cultural influence remains significant, with ongoing urban developments aimed at enhancing the city’s appeal, while recent reforms are set to expand its service sectors, including healthcare, tourism and telecommunications, driving continued growth.



18 Shenzhen China

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 3 Convention Center
- 5 Fortune 500

POPULATION

Metro 17,778,000

The Silicon Valley of China welcomes the world to its city-sized innovation district.

Nowhere is Shenzhen’s Silicon Valley of China moniker more appropriate than when strolling the city’s Huaqiangbei district. It buzzes with tech enthusiasts, inventors and global buyers, all drawn to its legendary electronics markets. You’ll see cutting-edge developments in everything from drones to smartphones, with tech giants like Huawei and Tencent setting the pace. This bustling metropolis continues to captivate with its impressive skyline and growing culture scene, from art galleries to indie cafes, while maintaining its standing as a global powerhouse. Recent economic developments have only strengthened Shenzhen’s position as a global leader. Ranking #7 in our overall Prosperity index, the city’s dominance in high-tech manufacturing and exports is undeniable. Shenzhen accounts for 11.6% of China’s total exports, and the city’s convention center, the largest in the world (and #3 in our Convention Center subcategory), plays host to international trade fairs, drawing business from across the globe. The city’s Top 5 ranking for Fortune 500 companies in Asia-Pacific cities further cements its role in the global economy. Looking ahead, Shenzhen is betting big on emerging industries like synthetic biology, robotics and genetic technology, ensuring its place at the forefront of innovation. As the city continues to evolve beyond its manufacturing roots, Shenzhen is set to define the future of global tech and trade.



19 Brisbane Australia

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 4 Air Quality
- 5 GDP per Capita

POPULATION

Metro 4,002,000

Rugged and refined, Brisbane is Australia’s stealthy thriving cultural hub.

Brisbane, Australia’s third-largest city, offers a seamless blend of natural beauty, modern sophistication and economic growth. Ranking #15 in our overall Livability index, buoyed by its #4 Air Quality ranking, Brisbane’s subtropical climate and proximity to the Gold Coast and Sunshine Coast make it an outdoor paradise (ranking #14 for Nature & Parks). The city is experiencing rapid growth, fueled by significant investments in urban development. The US\$3.6-billion Queen’s Wharf project, featuring a riverfront casino, luxury hotels and entertainment venues, is transforming Brisbane’s skyline and reinforcing its status as a major economic hub. Brisbane’s upcoming role as the host of the 2032 Olympics is set to accelerate its growth further. Preparations for the Games should bring tens of thousands of jobs to the city, particularly in construction and infrastructure development. Watch its already impressive #21 overall Prosperity index ranking to ascend in short order. The city is also expanding its cultural landscape, including the development of a new 1,500-seat glass theater in the South Bank precinct, which will enhance Brisbane’s reputation as a cultural destination. Despite its urbanization, Brisbane retains a relaxed, welcoming atmosphere. Its outdoor lifestyle is reflected in its many riverfront parks, promenades and weekend markets, where the city’s #13-ranked Labor Force Participation is on full display.



20 Perth Australia

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 3 GDP per Capita
- 4 Air Quality

POPULATION

Metro 2,101,000

Where resilience, wealth, culture and nature converge on Australia's far-flung west coast.

Australia's fourth-largest city is a thriving coastal metropolis known for its natural beauty, economic prosperity and cultural depth. Set on the western coast, Perth's #18 ranking in our overall Livability index, as well as its #22-ranked Prosperity, highlights its strong economic sectors such as mining, energy and technology. The city is also benefiting from significant investment in hospitality and tourism, with new luxury hotels and waterfront developments enhancing its appeal to both residents and visitors. No wonder it's in the Top 20 in our Google Trends subcategory. Perth's cultural scene is deeply influenced by its Indigenous heritage, particularly the Noongar Nation. The Six Seasons Gallery at the Art Gallery of Western Australia showcases over 3,000 Indigenous artworks, offering profound insights into Aboriginal life. At Optus Stadium, Noongar culture is celebrated through art installations, trails and digital storytelling, enriching the visitor experience beyond traditional sports and events. In terms of natural attractions, Perth ranks #32 for its Nature & Parks, thanks to its pristine beaches, 50 miles of coastline and the expansive Kings Park, one of the largest urban parks in the world. The city's commitment to preserving its natural environment, while also investing in sustainable urban development, has positioned Perth as a coveted hometown to watch.



21 Nagoya Japan

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 3 Price-to-Income Ratio
- 4 Tree Cover

POPULATION

Metro 9,439,000

Japan's "Detroit City" loves its cars, but also food, fantasy and fabulous shopping.

Completely rebuilt after the bombings of the Second World War, today's Nagoya boasts modern architectural marvels and opulent department stores, leaving no doubt that it ranks among Japan's wealthiest cities. With its rich historical significance as the birthplace of the first Shogun, Minamoto Yoritomo, and the origins of the Three Unifiers—Oda Nobunaga, Toyotomi Hideyoshi and the Shogun Tokugawa Iyasu—Nagoya ranks an impressive #8 in our overall Livability index, highlighted by its #3 ranking for Price-to-Income Ratio, #4 ranking for Tree Cover and #8 for Heat Stress. The city ranks Top 20 for its Museums, which speaks to the city's obscure tourist bounty: three Toyota museums (the automotive giant launched here), the SCMaglev and Railway Park museum, which celebrated 150 years of rail travel in the country last year, and a science museum featuring one of the world's largest planetariums. In 2022 the world's inaugural Studio Ghibli theme park opened as a 200-acre, five-theme ode to several of the studio's most beloved movies. Then, of course, there's the food culture that's among Japan's best, characterized as comfort food that balances sweetness with spices. With its Top 20 Global 500 Companies ranking, along with its #23-ranked Labor Force Participation, Nagoya enjoys a high overall Prosperity ranking (#39).



22 Sapporo Japan

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 2 Heat Stress
- 3 Healthcare System Index

POPULATION

Metro 2,168,000

Japan's fifth-largest city is increasingly a cool destination in all manner of the word.

Sapporo is one of Japan's newest and most orderly cities. With little in the way of traditional architecture, it lacks in that unique "Japanese-ness" of places like Tokyo and Kyoto, but makes up for it with opportunities for summer road trips and snowy winter adventures (don't miss the ice sculptures on Susukino and the castles and manga characters made of snow—with stops at the Sapporo Clock Tower and the open-air Historical Village of Hokkaido along the way). Of course, no visit to the city would be complete without stops at the Sapporo Beer Museum and the Asahi brewery, followed by a leisurely karaoke crawl around the bars of Susukino. Or a dip in one of the dozens of open-air hot-spring baths. Not surprisingly, the northern city ranks #9 in our overall Livability index, helped by its enviable #2 ranking for (lack of) Heat Stress, as well as #3 for both its Healthcare System, and its Tree Cover. The city is doubling down on its natural attributes with its new Second Sapporo City Development Strategic Vision that features sustainable urban development, focused on green infrastructure, such as increasing urban greenery (you can never have too much of a good thing) and enhancing public transportation.



23 Jakarta Indonesia

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 2 Instagram Hashtags
- 7 Facebook Check-ins

POPULATION

Metro 35,386,000

The planet's second-most-populous metropolis may be sinking, but it's not done yet.

Jakarta, the sprawling capital of Indonesia, is a city of contrasts—one that balances its status as the second-most populous metropolis on the planet with the pressing challenges of urban management and environmental threats. The city, after all, is sinking—some parts by as much as eight feet over the past decade—exacerbated by the depletion of the water table and rising sea levels from the Java Sea. The government has acknowledged the urgency of the situation, leading to the decision to relocate the capital to Nusantara, a new city being built 800 miles away on the island of Borneo. The city's #99-ranked Livability points to its peril. But Jakarta is not going anywhere, investing heavily in urban projects ranging from the expansion of its Mass Rapid Transit (MRT) lines and ongoing improvements to Soekarno-Hatta International Airport (ranked #34). Foreign investment is also betting big on the post-pandemic demand for business and international travel, with more than a dozen luxury hotels scheduled to open over the next four years. With an impressive #11 ranking in our overall Lovability index (including #2 for Instagram Hashtags and #7 for Facebook Check-ins), it's clear that locals and visitors from Asia and the world are smitten with this urban giant, as hobbled as it may be.



24 Hangzhou China

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 31 Convention Center
- 6 Global 500 Companies

POPULATION

Metro 9,618,000

China's romantic capital also loves the economic development fuelling its ascent.

Hangzhou is where ancient romance meets modern-day ingenuity, flipping traditional notions of a Chinese city on their head. Imagine exploring the legendary West Lake, the backdrop to China's most famous love story ("Madame White Snake"), or feeling the power of nature as you watch the tidal waves dance along the Qiantang River. But it's not just the scenery—it's a powerhouse of innovation, home to tech giants like Alibaba, where dreams and careers flourish side by side. By 2023, Hangzhou's economy had reached a level comparable to high-income countries, as defined by the World Bank, and today ranks #14 in our overall Prosperity index. A major initiative in 2023 to accelerate its digital economy landed the 2024 Global AI Conference (taking advantage of the #31-ranked convention center), positioning Hangzhou as a key player in artificial intelligence and advanced computing. Young, educated professionals are pouring in, according to government numbers. In 2023 Hangzhou's nearly 400,000 new residents under the age of 35 with college degrees led Chinese cities in net talent inflow, and the city added more than 320,000 new jobs last year. With the sixth most Global 500 Companies among Asia-Pacific cities, Hangzhou's already impressive #24 Unemployment Rate will continue falling.



25 Busan South Korea

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 16 Museums
- 18 Air Quality

POPULATION

Metro 3,843,000

South Korea's second city doubles down on its cultural and outdoor wealth.

Busan, South Korea's second-largest city, is equally loved for its urban sophistication and natural beauty. Literally: It ranks #35 in both our overall Lovability and Livability indexes. With its stunning beaches, mountains, and lush urban grid (it ranks #18 for Air Quality and #19 for Heat Stress), Busan is a haven for outdoor enthusiasts, with popular spots like Haeundae Beach and Gwangalli Beach sating watersport enthusiasts while hikers feast on the trails of Geumjeong Mountain. Recent additions to its #16-ranked museum scene, such as the Busan Museum of Contemporary Art (opened in 2022), have elevated the city's cultural profile. The museum focuses on eco-friendly art and digital exhibitions, making it a favorite among younger audiences and environmental advocates. Another key highlight is the Busan International Film Festival (BIFF), which has grown into one of Asia's premier film events. The city has invested heavily in expanding its cultural infrastructure to host even more global art exhibitions and festivals by 2025, with plans for a new Korean War Memorial Museum aimed at preserving South Korea's complex history. The city is increasingly sharing in Seoul's prosperity, with the Busan New Port Expansion Project sure to enhance the city's global trade networks when it opens in 2027.



26 Adelaide Australia

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 2 Air Quality
- 5 Heat Stress

POPULATION

Metro 1,271,000

Clean living and a booming economy have the world sweet on Adelaide.

Adelaide lives the good life as the capital of South Australia. Its #25 ranking in our overall Livability index is powered by its abundant green spaces that help it rank #2 for Air Quality and #5 for Heat Stress. It does well in our Lovability index as well (#37), a testament to its renowned food and wine culture and proximity to nearby regions like the Barossa Valley. Urban projects like the Riverbank Precinct revitalization will give citizens and enlightened visitors a vibrant cultural and entertainment district along the Torrens River. The city's commitment to sustainability is reflected in its ambitious targets for renewable energy, with South Australia leading the nation in wind and solar power generation. With its #16 Parks and Nature, #21 Price-to-Income Ratio and #26 Nightlife, it's no wonder word is getting out about Australia's fifth-largest city. The economy is also booming (the city ranks #41 in our Prosperity index) as investments in defense, renewable energy and healthcare have positioned Adelaide as a center for innovation and growth. The ongoing Lot Fourteen development, set to be completed in 2025, is a prime example of this, transforming the former Royal Adelaide Hospital site into a hub for technology, innovation and the arts.



27 Fukuoka Japan

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 12 GDP Per Capita
- 13 Air Quality

POPULATION

Metro 2,368,000

An urban rebirth and a start-up wave in southern Japan.

Japan's sixth-largest city, situated at the northern tip of Kyushu, boasts a strategic location between Tokyo, Seoul and Shanghai, making it a vital gateway for trade and culture in the region. As one of Japan's largest port cities, Fukuoka is not just a hub of economic activity but also a city renowned for its exceptional quality of life, ranking #24 in our overall Livability index. Its impressive #13 Air Quality ranking and #21 spot for Tree Cover will only improve with plans to expand the beloved Ohori Park and enhance coastal areas like Momochi Beach. The city's economic growth is robust, as evidenced by its #43 Prosperity ranking, and Fukuoka has successfully attracted a younger workforce, a significant achievement in a country facing demographic challenges. Its #12 -ranked GDP Per Capita and #31 Labor Force Participation ranking demonstrates this, with local talent that's drawing entrepreneurs and tech companies. The city has invested heavily in creating a supportive ecosystem for start-ups, including the establishment of the Fukuoka Growth Next, a leading incubation center that fosters innovation and entrepreneurship. The city's proactive approach to urban development includes the Tenjin Big Bang project, which is transforming the downtown with new skyscrapers, expanded office spaces and modern amenities, all set to be completed by 2028.



28 Hanoi Vietnam

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 3 Shopping
- 4 Unemployment Rate

POPULATION

Metro 6,359,000

Vietnam's capital leverages its serenity to get a piece of global innovation.

Hanoi, the political and cultural heart of Vietnam, is a tangle of ancient temples, bustling markets, and the serene Hoan Kiem Lake. Its grip on visitors and locals alike is obvious by its #16 ranking in our overall Lovability index, with attractions like the Imperial Citadel of Thang Long—a UNESCO World Heritage site—drawing travelers from around the globe and inspiring them to leave the fourth-most Tripadvisor Reviews among all cities in our ranking. Hanoi also boasts the Top 3 shopping and the fifth-best nightlife, whether you prefer traditional revelry in the Old Quarter, or exploring the fast-rising Tay Ho area.

Economically, Hanoi is also ascendant, with the fourth-lowest unemployment rate in our ranking and new initiatives like the "Hanoi Smart City Project," set for completion by 2028, that is transforming the city into a digital hub, with state-of-the-art facilities and smart governance systems designed to attract international businesses and tech start-ups. Hanoi's hospitality market is also on the rise, with the city expecting a boom in tourism for the rest of the decade. According to local projections, more than 60 new hotels and 11,000 rooms, are set to open by 2025, with the majority of these being five-star establishments.



29 Johor Bahru Malaysia

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 1 GDP Per Capita
- 6 Tree Cover

POPULATION

Metro 2,040,000

A key gateway between Malaysia and Singapore becomes a vital economic and cultural hub.

Strategically bordering Singapore, Johor Bahru is quickly becoming a destination for Malaysian nationals and global talent alike. The city's proximity to Singapore gives it a competitive edge, providing businesses and professionals with easy access to the region's financial hub while offering a more affordable cost of living (the city ranks #11 in our Price-to-Income Ratio subcategory). Its #31 overall Prosperity ranking is driven by its robust industrial sectors and ongoing development projects. The Iskandar Malaysia Project, a major initiative to transform the region into a global metropolis, is at the heart of the city's growth. Spanning 850 square miles, the build-out encompasses infrastructure, education and healthcare, attracting billions in foreign investment. Additionally, Johor Bahru has established itself as a significant player in the tourism and retail sectors, with Johor Premium Outlets and Legoland Malaysia Resort drawing millions of visitors annually.

The city's impressive #26 Livability ranking is helped by its #6 Tree Cover ranking and its commitment to expanding green spaces across the city. The development of the Iskandar Waterfront City Eco Park in 2023 has already added significant recreational green spaces for residents, and there are plans for more parks and green corridors powered by projects aimed at further integrating parks and eco-friendly zones into the city's core.



30 Chengdu China

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 3 Airport Connectivity
- 12 Fortune 500

POPULATION

Metro 15,016,000

Elevated ambition in one of China's largest cities.

Chengdu, the relaxed yet bustling capital of Sichuan province, is known for its vibrant culture, iconic landmarks and delicious cuisine—the result of the city's centuries-old overland route to the Tibetan highlands. The city's impressive #18 ranking in our overall Prosperity index is powered by the 12th-highest number of Fortune 500 companies in our ranking. Intel, Foxconn and Siemens have major operations in Chengdu, while the establishment of new R&D centers and tech incubators has attracted recent investment from companies like Huawei and Alibaba. The Chengdu Hi-Tech Industrial Development Zone is one of the largest of its kind, housing over 3,000 tech companies and contributing significantly to economic growth (Chengdu ranks #47 in our GDP per Capita subcategory). Given all the commerce, it's no wonder the city is a crucial logistics hub, with the Chengdu Tianfu International Airport ranking #3 for Airport Connectivity and on track to handle more than 60 million passengers annually by 2025. Massive infrastructure investment is everywhere. By 2030, the Tianfu Greenway Project will add an astonishing 10,500 miles of greenways and public spaces. At the same time, the Chengdu-Chongqing Economic Circle, an ambitious regional development plan, is designed to transform the region into one of China's primary economic growth engines.



31 Penang Malaysia

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 3 Unemployment Rate
- 6 Tree Cover

POPULATION

Metro 1,704,000

Malaysia's livable gem is protecting what matters while embracing entrepreneurialism.

Known for its UNESCO World Heritage-listed George Town, Penang combines the charm of old-world architecture with the energy of a city on the rise. The island city's streets are filled with a colorful mix of street art, colonial buildings, and lively markets, contributing to its #22 ranking in our overall Livability index, including a #6 ranking for its Tree Cover and #18 ranking for its Healthcare System. But the city is sprinting into its future, with major urban development projects fast changing its skyline. The Batu Kawan Industrial Park is a magnet for international tech firms like Broadcom, bringing jobs and boosting Penang's economic growth, anchored by Asia-Pacific's third-lowest unemployment rate and the #9-ranked Labor Force Participation.

Tourism continues to play a major role in Penang's growth, with recent efforts focusing on revitalizing George Town's waterfront and promoting eco-tourism across the island's stunning parks and beaches. City leaders are also bringing that natural bounty to the urban grid, with sustainability initiatives such as the Penang Green Agenda 2030 aiming to preserve its rich cultural heritage while enhancing its urban environment with greener public spaces and improved waste management systems.



32 Chongqing China

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 6 Convention Center
- 7 Airport Connectivity

POPULATION

Metro 12,653,000

A megacity powered by cultural heritage stakes its future claim among Chinese urban giants.

Chongqing's sprawling landscape, perched on canyon slopes and brimming with history, offers no shortage of grand experiences. Take a cable car ride across the Yangtze River for a stunning view of the skyline or cruise down the Yangtze River, discovering historical treasures like Baidi City and Zhang Fei Temple, which showcase Chongqing's deep cultural roots. Doing so will make you wonder how this place only ranks #33 for its Sights & Landmarks (hint: it hasn't been discovered by global urban travelers yet).

Home to more than 12 million residents (and twice that many around it), Chongqing is much more than a city—it's a testament to China's westward economic development. Ranking #23 in our overall Prosperity index (including #7 for both its connected airport and #6 for its massive convention center), the city is transforming rapidly, even by China's twitchy standards. The Chongqing Municipal Government's 2024 master plan outlines a vision to elevate the city to international mega-city status by 2035, positioning it as a global gateway and a central hub for international exchanges in China's heartland. With five civilian airports serving the city, a sixth is planned to open by 2035, propelling the city into the top ranks of global aviation hubs.



33 Kunming China

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 5 Convention Center
- 10 Airport Connectivity

POPULATION

Metro 4,995,000

China's City of Eternal Spring is blooming like never before.

There's the UNESCO-listed Yunnan Stone Forest offering a surreal landscape of towering limestone formations, and the serene Dianchi Lake inviting reflection. But Kunming is more than just its natural wonders; it's a cultural mosaic where China's diverse ethnic minorities showcase their vibrant traditions, adding a colorful flair to this already enchanting city.

It's no surprise then that Kunming ranks #46 in our overall Livability index, with its consistently pleasant climate making it an ideal place to live. As the bustling capital of Yunnan Province, it also secures an even more impressive #19 spot in our overall Prosperity index. Kunming is on an ambitious path, pushing forward with the development of Mohan International Port City, set to become a pivotal gateway to South and Southeast Asia. And let's not forget the flowers—Kunming is a global floral powerhouse, with its cut flower exports making up over 40% of China's total. Last year, the city government unveiled bold new e-commerce investments to help the industry bloom. Kunming also shines as a major player in the exhibition world (ranking Top 5 for its convention center) and hosts marquee events like the China Kunming Import and Export Commodities Fair, the China International Travel Mart, and the China Kunming International Tourism Festival.



34 Chennai India

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 9 Sights & Landmarks
- 11 Google Trends

POPULATION

Metro 11,570,000

Tech meets beach in India's sustainably ambitious coastal gem.

India's fourth-largest city may be famed for its sun-drenched Marina Beach and vibrant cultural scene, but this coastal metropolis has evolved into a vital South Asian economic engine as well. Post-pandemic, Chennai has witnessed substantial investment, particularly in its IT and industrial sectors. The city may only rank #64 in our overall Prosperity ranking, driven by robust infrastructure and corporate investments, but is doubling down on its #22-ranked Business Ecosystem with developments like the expansion of the Mahindra World City, an Eliambadu Village project estimated to generate more than 2,000 jobs and elevate Chennai's status as a tech and industrial corridor. Urban infrastructure, by way of The Smart City mission, prioritizes sustainability, from recently upgraded public transport to digital governance initiatives. The city is building on its natural assets with projects like the Adyar Eco Park adding to the overall environmental sensibility here. Tourism has long been a key driver in Chennai's growth, helping rank the city #22 in our overall Lovability index, with a #9 ranking for Sights & Landmarks and #11 for Google Trends. The completion of several hospitality projects—including the opening of new luxury hotels like the Leela Palace Chennai and Taj Wellington Mews—reflects the city's ongoing commitment to cater to domestic and international visitors.



35 Ho Chi Minh City Vietnam

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 3 Nightlife
- 4 Unemployment Rate

POPULATION

Metro 14,953,000

Vietnam's massive metro is doing right by citizens while drawing the world.

Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam's largest metropolis, is a vibrant cultural hub with some of the best nightlife, shopping and online kudos in our entire ranking (Facebook Check-ins rank #9 and Tripadvisor Reviews rank #7). No wonder it ranks #17 overall in our vital Lovability index, something that's likely to improve in the coming years with new upscale venues and international entertainment brands like Papaya Papa and Shri, with their panoramic city views and bold cocktails. This year's Saigon Night Market Expansion has brought new food and drink stalls, more live music stages and extended hours, making one of Asia's largest open-air night markets even more bustling. The #7-ranked Shopping scene got a boost in 2023 with the reopening of the Union Square luxury mall, and in 2025 the Landmark 81 tower will become one of Southeast Asia's tallest and most prestigious shopping venues. The city's #75 Livability ranking will improve with its #37-ranked Air Quality subcategory, and new investment into public and green spaces with new Saigon River placemaking projects transforming the waterfront into a buzzing outdoor hub with parks, jogging paths and open-air cafes. The expansion of the Bach Dang Wharf Park, set to be completed in 2025, will add green spaces, public art and waterfront activities.



36 Pune India

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 12 Price-to-Income Ratio
- 13 Google Trends

POPULATION

Metro 6,819,000

The Oxford of the East thrives on intellectual might and economic growth.

Pune's academic foundations, anchored by institutions such as Savitribai Phule Pune University, continue to attract top talent, nurturing a vibrant student and innovation culture. The city's kinetic streets—especially those like FC Road—are lined with independent cafes, bookstores and cultural hubs. Pune's enduring appeal is further reflected in its #23 rank in our overall Lovability index, with students, residents and visitors singing its praises and powering it to a #13 ranking for both Google Trends and Instagram Hashtags. Despite Pune's rapid urban development, tranquil enclaves such as Koregaon Park, with its tree-lined streets and serene green spaces, offer respite from the city's bustling pace, helping Pune to a #21 ranking for Sights & Landmarks and #19 for Nature & Parks. With strongholds in the IT and automotive sectors, supported by industry titans like Tata Motors, Infosys and Bajaj Auto, the city ranks #60 in our overall Prosperity index (although that's poised to improve, especially with its impressive affordability, ranking #12 for Price-to-Income Ratio). The Maharashtra government's concerted efforts to attract almost US\$2 billion in investments over the next two years underscore Pune's economic ambition, with an expected creation of 30,000 new jobs. A newly expanded international airport will help, too.



37 Sendai Japan

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 1 Tree Cover
- 4 Price-to-Income Ratio

POPULATION

Metro 1,280,000

The gateway to Japan's northern treasures is a naturally livable treasure.

Sendai, Japan's 11th-largest city, is a hidden gem that perfectly balances urban life with the tranquility of nature, confirmed by its #21 ranking in our overall Livability index. Just a 90-minute bullet train ride from Tokyo, Sendai feels like a world apart, offering a refreshing blend of safety, affordability (it ranks #4 in our Price-to-Income Ratio subcategory) and culture. Given its #1 ranking in our Tree Cover subcategory, Sendai is appropriately known as the City of Trees, and its urban landscape is marked by a lush canopy that integrates seamlessly with the city's mountainous and coastal surroundings that also help it rank #6 for Heat Stress. It also boasts some of Asia's best air quality, ranking #8.

Culturally, Sendai is vibrant, hosting numerous festivals throughout the year that celebrate everything from traditional arts to local cuisine. The remains of the 17th-century Aoba Castle, perched on Aoba Hill, offer a historical backdrop to a city that is as visually stunning as it is culturally rich. Whether you're exploring the city's landmarks or venturing 30 minutes out of town for surfing on northern Japan's swells or skiing at Spring Valley Izumi Kogen ski resort, Sendai is a sensory feast for visitors and locals alike.



38 Xiamen China

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 9 Convention Center
- 12 Fortune 500

POPULATION

Metro 5,253,000

A fast-growing retiree haven tries to keep the economic engine revving.

Xiamen's narrow lanes and historic arcade buildings reflect its deep-rooted connection to overseas Chinese communities and the remittances that funded the city's growth (to say nothing of the reinvestment upon the return of these émigrés). Gulangyu Island, a must-see for visitors, is known for its distinctive mansions that hearken back to the days when globally mobile residents played a crucial role in shaping Xiamen's growth in the image of what they found in Southeast Asia and beyond. It is the only Special Economic Zone in China created specifically because of its proximity to Taiwan and the island nation's investment has long been a significant part of Xiamen's economy, driving its #12 ranking for Fortune 500 companies. However, rising tensions across the Taiwan Strait and frequent military drills in the area have led to growing concerns among Taiwanese investors. Fears of a potential conflict have resulted in investments being delayed or cancelled, causing Xiamen's economic growth to slow significantly over the past year. The ongoing strait tensions continue to cast a shadow over the city's economic prospects, with Xiamen's impressive #28 overall Prosperity ranking at risk. Even with these challenges, Xiamen remains an attractive place to live and visit, ranking #34 in our overall Livability index.



39 Xi'an China

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 5 Airport Connectivity
- 16 Fortune 500

POPULATION

Metro 12,211,000

China's global home of the electric car maneuvers a road of tariffs and shifting economics.

Xi'an, revered in China for its millennia of history, is not just a symbol of the country's ancient past but a rapidly evolving city that blends tradition with modernity. Situated near the Qinling Mountains, Xi'an is home to globally iconic sites like the Terracotta Army of Emperor Qin Shi Huang. The city's rich cultural tapestry continues to attract both locals and tourists, with bustling spots like the Tang Paradise Night Market offering an immersive experience where visitors often don traditional Tang dynasty attire. Ranking #39 in our Museums subcategory, and #42 for its Tripadvisor Reviews, Xi'an's charm as a cultural powerhouse is well-documented globally, powering its overall #62 Lovability ranking.

But it's Xi'an's economic story that's driving interest these days, as the city of more than 12 million embraces its evolution as an automotive sector powerhouse, home to carmakers like BYD. As the sector faced a downturn this year under the pall of global tariffs on Chinese electric vehicles, local government initiatives have focused on expanding high-tech industries and green energy projects, with plans to make Xi'an a center for renewable energy technology by 2030. The city's #27 overall Prosperity ranking, therefore, is on solid footing, connected to the world by its Top 5 airport.



40 Wuhan China

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 7 Convention Center
- 19 Airport Connectivity

POPULATION

Metro 10,353,000

The megacity synonymous with the outbreak of Covid-19 resumes its hobbled ascent.

Few people outside of Asia had heard of Wuhan before 2020, but as ground zero of the Covid-19 pandemic, the city quickly became global front-page news. Five years after the coronavirus outbreak, Wuhan is getting up off the mat. In addition to being the country's high-speed rail network hub (connecting 80% of China's major cities within four hours), the city also ranks #19 in our Airport Connectivity subcategory. Happily, Wuhan is also investing locally, yielding astonishing tech innovations like the 2022 launch of Baidu's Apollo Go, the world's first commercial self-driving taxi service, as part of a larger push to become a hub for smart cities and sustainable transport. Wuhan's urban development is equally ambitious, with plans to invest heavily in emerging industries like advanced manufacturing, healthcare and renewable energy, aiming to generate more than US\$14 billion by 2027. At the heart of this technological and industrial boom is the Wuhan East Lake High-tech Development Zone, also known as the Optics Valley of China. As a national-level development zone, it's rapidly attracting global investment, talent and high-tech firms. Expect its #19 ranking for Fortune 500 companies to improve as the pall of the pandemic lifts and major events return to the #7-ranked Convention Center, improving the city's overall #24 Prosperity ranking.



41 Phnom Penh Cambodia

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 1 Unemployment Rate
- 2 Labor Force Participation

POPULATION

Metro 2,196,000

After decades under a brutal dictatorship, Cambodia's capital is a city ascendant.

As the scars of the Khmer Rouge regime slowly heal, Phnom Penh is rapidly positioning itself as a major hub for investors, expatriates and global businesses. Powered by the lowest unemployment rate and second-highest labor force participation in our ranking, Phnom Penh sits an impressive #25 in our overall Prosperity index. The next decade will see significant expansions, led by major projects like the continued development of Olympia City and the expansion of Diamond Island (Koh Pich) that are not just reshaping the city's skyline but also attracting foreign direct investment and international businesses. Aeon Mall and Raffles Hotel are just a few of the global names establishing a strong presence in the city, drawn by its strategic location and economic potential. The upcoming City Center 2 project is another highlight, promising to redefine Phnom Penh's skyline with state-of-the-art office towers and luxury residences and further bolstering the city's status as a regional business hub. The Global Tech Exchange, a forthcoming business district dedicated to tech innovation, is expected to be a game-changer for the city, attracting international tech companies and fostering a robust start-up ecosystem (which is sure to improve its #72 Business Ecosystem ranking). An ambitious airport expansion should be ready by the end of the decade.



42 Kolkata India

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 7 Google Trends
- 13 Facebook Check-ins

POPULATION

Metro 21,747,000

A colonial megalopolis revels in its lovability and promising future.

Kolkata traces its strategic role in global commerce back to the late 1600s, when the British East India Company established a key trading post here. Often referred to as the City of Joy, Kolkata's charm lies in its ability to marry its rich colonial heritage with modern urban dynamism. Ranking #19 in our overall Lovability index, Kolkata's streets hum with the intellectual vitality that shaped India's independence movement, with renowned figures like Rabindranath Tagore and Subhas Chandra Bose having once called the city home. From the buzzing literary cafes of College Street to the timeless appeal of the Howrah Bridge, the city embodies both tradition and resilience, reflected in its #13 spot for Facebook Check-ins and #19 for Instagram Hashtags. Kolkata's #15 ranking in Museums speaks to its deep-rooted commitment to cultural preservation. Institutions such as the Indian Museum, Asia's oldest, have recently unveiled new galleries that underscore Kolkata's continued influence as a cultural touchstone, where the legacies of British colonialism and Bengal's own vibrant artistic and political movements are curated and celebrated. While historically an industrial giant, the city is now repositioning itself—powered by a recent \$1.8-billion government investment package that promises to revitalize Kolkata's economic fabric, particularly in infrastructure and local industries.



43 Hyderabad India

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 7 Price-to-Income Ratio
- 12 Google Trends

POPULATION

Metro 9,797,000

A harmonious blend of historic grandeur and cutting-edge innovation.

Hyderabad, the "City of Pearls" and "Cyberabad," seamlessly unites its opulent past with a thriving, technology-driven future. In the Old City, the iconic Charminar and bustling Laad Bazaar transport visitors to an era when the Nizam's court was synonymous with wealth and elegance. Across the city, the grandeur of Golconda Fort and the intricate architecture of the Mecca Masjid underscore Hyderabad's rich cultural tapestry, earning it a Top 25 spot for our Sights & Landmarks subcategory. The city's impressive affordability is showcased by its #7 ranking for Price-to-Income Ratio, and powers the city's overall Lovability, for which it ranks #33. Yet Hyderabad's legacy extends beyond its history. The city has emerged as one of India's premier tech hubs, with HITEC City and Gachibowli representing its dynamic transformation. This "Cyberabad" corridor is home to industry giants like Amazon, Google and Infosys, propelling the city to a #18 Business Ecosystem ranking. The addition of T-Hub 2.0, the world's largest innovation campus, further solidifies Hyderabad's role in fostering start-ups and driving India's IT boom. The ambitious Pharma City project, set to become the world's largest pharmaceutical manufacturing cluster, and ongoing metro expansions are enhancing infrastructure to support the city's rapid growth. Expect Hyderabad's #35 Fortune 500 companies ranking to improve in short order.



44 Taichung Taiwan

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 7 Nature & Parks
- 7 Healthcare System Index

POPULATION

Metro 2,517,000

Arts and culture meet the good life on Taiwan's west coast.

Positioned at the crossroads of industry and a tradition of prioritizing the good life, Taiwan's second-largest city captivates proud locals and grateful visitors with its urban vibrancy (including the #16-ranked Sights & Landmarks like its traditional temples) and natural splendor (#17 for Tree Cover). It's no wonder that the city ranks #17 in our overall Livability index. One of the most mesmerizing experiences is watching the sunset at the Gaomei Wetlands, where the sky transforms the landscape into a surreal, mirrored reflection on the tidal flats. At night, the bustling Fengjia Night Market—Taiwan's largest—comes alive with aromas and the signature taste of bubble tea, validating its #19 Shopping subcategory spot. Economically, Taichung stands as a pillar of Taiwan's manufacturing industry, particularly in precision machinery and bicycle manufacturing. Giant Bicycles, headquartered in the city, symbolizes the city's high-end industrial prowess. The city's embrace of Taiwan's renewable energy investment in solar and offshore wind farms, as well as its Green Energy Industry Park, aims to establish Taichung as a leader in Taiwan's energy transition by 2030. The Shuinan Economic and Trade Park—a sprawling development zone focused on creating a smart, sustainable urban center—reflects Taichung's ambition to integrate its famed technology, green space and commerce in one iconic place.



45 Kaohsiung Taiwan

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 5 Healthcare System Index
- 15 Sights & Landmarks

POPULATION

Metro 2,346,000

Taiwan's often-overlooked second city is an ascendant cultural and economic dynamo.

Known for its bustling port and maritime history, Kaohsiung is Taiwan's second-largest city and ranks an impressive Top 20 in our overall Livability index, reflecting its elevated quality of life and dedication to sustainable future-focused urban development. The city's skyline is blooming, blending modern skyscrapers with expansive parks and offering residents an attractive balance between urban convenience and natural beauty.

Kaohsiung is also a city committed to growth, driven by significant investments in green energy and sustainability. By 2031, Kaohsiung will have completed its light rail transit system, with three additional lines adding to the first already operational, dramatically improving eco-friendly transport options. This ambitious project is part of Kaohsiung's broader green initiative to reduce carbon emissions and improve air quality (already ranking an impressive #23). Kaohsiung is also developing its nascent reputation as a hotspot for global events, with a variety of concerts and festivals drawing both local and international visitors. No wonder tourism is booming, with more than 60 million visitors arriving in 2023 alone. Kaohsiung's tourism board has ambitious plans to grow the US\$97 billion in GDP that the city generated in 2023, while the #19-ranked Fortune 500 companies provide the ballast for a balanced economy going forward.



46 Fuzhou China

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 14 Convention Center
- 15 Tree Cover

POPULATION

Metro 4,487,000

A deeply revered coastal city is reborn as a green giant.

Fuzhou, located along China's southeastern coast, is deeply connected to the global Chinese diaspora and is often referred to as the "historic homeland for overseas Chinese." Many early Chinese emigrants to Southeast Asia and beyond trace their roots here, making the city a cultural hub for global visitors. The city continues to pulse with traditional practices, from clan rituals to deity processions. Historic districts like Sanfang Qixiang (Three Lanes and Seven Alleys) are well-preserved reminders of Fuzhou's past, including its role in the birth of China's modern navy. Natural attractions, such as the rugged Pingtan Island and the serene landscapes of Qingyun Mountain, showcase Fuzhou's natural beauty, evidenced by its #15 ranking in our Tree Cover subcategory. Urban renewal projects are also helping the city's overall #36 Livability ranking, with a recent focus on waterfront revitalization and a commitment to improving water quality across more than 100 rivers draining into its urban grid. As a result, Fuzhou has caught the eyes of both domestic and foreign investments, particularly in tech and green industries. The government's strategic focus on sustainable development has spurred international partnerships, and the city is positioning itself as a green tech hub that will improve its already impressive #37 ranking in our overall Prosperity category.



47 Jaipur India

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 8 Shopping
- 9 Facebook Check-ins

POPULATION

Metro 4,360,000

The Pink City swirls history, culture, and modernity into a much-loved urban masterpiece.

Jaipur, the Pink City of India, founded in 1727 by Maharaja Jai Singh II, is where history and modern grandeur pulse with every sunrise. The city's distinctive pink sandstone buildings were originally painted to welcome the Prince of Wales in 1876, a gesture of hospitality that has since become a symbol of Jaipur's warmth and elegance. As one of India's first planned cities, Jaipur is renowned for its strategic layout based on Vastu Shastra and ancient astronomy, reflecting Maharaja Jai Singh's brilliance in both governance and science.

The city's Top 20 spot in our overall Lovability index underscores its broad appeal, drawn from its rich tapestry of landmarks and experiences. From the majestic Amber Fort to the iconic Hawa Mahal (Palace of Winds) and the bustling Johari Bazaar, Jaipur's #30 ranking in our Sights & Landmarks subcategory is well-deserved. These sites are more than just tourist attractions, however. They are living embodiments of the city's royal legacy and are part of ongoing efforts to enhance accessibility and improve visitor experiences through projects like the Jaipur Heritage Tourism Plan, which focuses on preserving and promoting the city's historical sites. Jaipur is also improving its #86 Prosperity index ranking, with new investment in infrastructure and sustainable growth across key sectors like tourism, handicrafts and education.



48 Denpasar Indonesia

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 8 Unemployment Rate
- 24 Price-to-Income Ratio

POPULATION

Metro 1,326,000

Bali's urban heart blends cultural allure with outdoor adventure increasingly coveted by global travelers.

Denpasar, the capital of Bali and a vital gateway to Indonesia's most popular island destination, comes by its impressive #31 Livability ranking naturally, thanks to its balance of cultural heritage, modern amenities and access to nature. As the primary economic and political hub of Bali, Denpasar plays a key role in shaping the island's tourism-driven economy, while also making strides in urban development and sustainability. Denpasar's #26 ranking for Tree Cover and #28 for Air Quality highlight the city's unique proximity to both urban and natural beauty. Popular outdoor attractions include the nearby beaches of Sanur, known for its calm waters and stunning sunrises, and Serangan Island, a haven for water sports enthusiasts. The Taman Ayun Temple offers tranquil, scenic landscapes for visitors to experience Balinese spiritual life. As part of Bali's ongoing development plans, the Bali Cultural Village project, set for completion by 2027, will further enhance Denpasar's outdoor offerings by creating eco-friendly parks and recreational areas, including new cycling paths and public green spaces. Also lauded for its cultural significance, Denpasar is rich in historical landmarks, art galleries and traditional markets. The city's #48 ranking for Lovability reflects its appeal to both residents and tourists who share their adventures readily, as indicated by the city's #24 ranking for Tripadvisor Reviews.



49 Dalian China

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 11 Heat Stress
- 21 Nature & Parks

POPULATION

Metro 4,177,000

"The Pearl of Northern China" is redefining the concept of a modern port city.

Boasting almost 1,400 miles of coastline, Dalian seamlessly combines natural beauty with urban sophistication. From the golden sands of Jinshitan Beach to the dramatic cliffs of Laotieshan, and the scenic charm of Bangchuidao Island, the city offers a coastal allure that rivals many global seaside destinations (despite most Westerners never having heard of it), with a #11 ranking for Heat Stress and with Nature & Parks at #21. Meanwhile, Xinghai Square, the world's largest city square, reflects Dalian's grand ambitions, blending open spaces with striking modern architecture.

Economically, Dalian is a powerhouse that ranks #34 in our overall Prosperity index, underpinned by its diversified economy spanning manufacturing, finance and services. Once known for its petrochemical prowess, the city is now pivoting toward innovation-driven growth. In August 2024, the government unveiled a visionary plan to establish Dalian as a leading hub for emerging marine industries, focusing on sustainable development and marine technology. This initiative aligns with the city's strategic goal of transforming into a modern marine metropolis. Dalian's prosperity extends beyond economic metrics. With a 2023 GDP at almost \$119B, the city ranks #28 in GDP per Capita, reflecting its ability to channel economic growth into improved quality of life for its residents.



50 Tainan Taiwan

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 2 Healthcare System Index
- 17 Tree Cover

POPULATION

Metro 1,118,000

A cultural heartland preserves Taiwan's traditions while embracing future growth.

Tainan, often referred to as the cradle of Taiwan's cultural heritage, offers a glimpse into a Taiwan that has remained untouched by the rapid modernization of its northern cities. The city's historic streets are alive with ancient traditions, from vibrant wedding ceremonies to incense-filled temples like the Confucius Temple, the oldest in Taiwan. The historic city boasts the 17th-best Tree Cover in our ranking and, not surprisingly, also ranks Top 20 in our Sights & Landmarks subcategory. Known for its bustling night markets, Tainan is a culinary delight. Garden Night Market is a must-visit, with its maze of food stalls serving local delicacies such as oyster omelettes and coffin bread. The city's renowned beef soup, often savored in the early morning hours, is a testament to its strong food culture. All these considered, preserved urban experiences contributed to Tainan's #19 ranking in our overall Livability index. Once known primarily for agriculture and sugar production, the city is now attracting significant foreign investment. Its #34 Labor Force Participation powers the #35 Fortune 500 ranking, driven by technology and renewable energy and projects like the Tainan Science Park, a hub for tech innovation, particularly in semiconductor manufacturing, key to Taiwan's tech ecosystem.



51 Kollam India

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 4 Healthcare System Index
- 5 Rent

POPULATION

Metro 1,576,000

Kerala's backwater gateway blends heritage, industry and serenity.

Kollam, often called the "Gateway to Kerala's Backwaters" for its strategic location on Ashtamudi Lake, is a cross-hatch of waterways that are the lifelines supporting its tourism, trade and the livelihoods of more than 1.5 million. These shimmering backwaters, coupled with Kollam's lush landscapes, contribute to the city's impressive Livability Index ranking of #16, including Top 10 Tree Cover and Top 5 spots for both its affordable rent and healthcare system. Historically renowned for its bustling trade in spices, coir and cashews, Kollam remains a cornerstone of Kerala's economy. The Port of Kollam, a key player in regional trade, underpins the city's logistics network. Although Kollam ranks a dismal #142 in our overall Prosperity index, significant transformation is on the horizon. Kerala's ambitious multi-billion-dollar investment plan includes projects like the Cashew Export Zone and the expansion of Kollam Port, aiming to elevate the city's role as an economic powerhouse. Kollam's Integrated Urban Development Plan mirrors its forward-thinking approach. Upgraded roads, modern residential complexes and enhanced public spaces align with the city's livability goals. Investments in green spaces and transportation infrastructure promise a better quality of life for residents while attracting new business opportunities, especially agriculture.



52 Bandung Indonesia

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 4 Instagram Hashtags
- 23 Google Trends

POPULATION

Metro 7,203,000

Indonesia's creative city balances cool mountain air and entrepreneurial energy.

Nestled in the lush highlands of West Java, Bandung offers a refreshing alternative to Indonesia's bustling urban centers. Often called the "Paris of Java" for its colonial architecture and fashion-forward culture, Bandung combines natural beauty, artistic vibrancy and an emerging entrepreneurial spirit. Stroll through the lively Braga Street, where art deco buildings house eclectic boutiques, cafes and galleries, or unwind in the city's cooler climate, a welcome respite from Indonesia's tropical heat. Doing so reveals why the city ranks an impressive #21 in our overall Lovability index, including #4 in our Instagram Hashtags subcategory and Top 25 spots for both Google Trends and Facebook Check-ins.

Nearby, the Dago Pakar area, Tangkuban Perahu Volcano and Kawah Putih crater lake provide stunning natural getaways, cementing the city's reputation as a retreat for nature lovers and its #36-ranked Nature & Parks. Bandung's green spaces do a lot of the heavy lifting for its overall Livability index ranking of #56, and reflect its dedication to creating a balance between urban growth and natural bounty. The revitalization of the Cikapundung River and the creation of parks like Teras Cikapundung add to the network of nature trails, tea plantations and vibrant city parks such as Babakan Siliwangi Forest Walk, a serene urban escape.



53 Manila Philippines

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 17 Labor Force Participation
- 23 Air Quality

POPULATION

Metro 24,156,000

The urban heart of the Philippines is open for business. Please excuse the traffic.

Manila, the kinetic capital of the Philippines, is a dynamic metropolis of stark contrasts where colonial history and stunning landmarks and museums (ranked #44) are juxtaposed against traffic congestion and aging infrastructure. The city's historically global importance is on full display with Intramuros, the walled city that has preserved centuries of Spanish colonial architecture, and Binondo—home to the world's oldest Chinatown. No wonder the city ranks #40 for Lovability, with its urban gems coaxing Top 25 Facebook Check-ins across a vibrant urban playground that includes #42-ranked nightlife. The city's infrastructural challenges are a priority, with the "Build, Build, Build" infrastructure program aiming to alleviate congestion and modernize mobility. Projects like the Manila Subway (slated for completion by 2028) and the rehabilitation of Ninoy Aquino International Airport aim to improve transportation, reduce travel times and enhance the city's connectivity (currently ranking #30). Green spaces and urban park expansion is designed to offset the density and provide more recreational areas for increasingly densifying residents. Economically, Manila holds a #49 ranking in Prosperity, reflecting its role as the economic heart of the Philippines. Foreign investment is pouring into key sectors like real estate, technology and finance, with the ongoing development of Bonifacio Global City as a premier business hub.



54 Nanjing China

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 12 Unemployment Rate
- 27 Museums

POPULATION

Metro 8,507,000

Vibrant neighborhoods, culinary excellence and a dedication to preserving a historical soul.

Nanjing, the "Historic Heart of China," served as the capital of six dynasties, and its 3,000-year history is etched into landmarks (ranked #45) like Purple Mountain, Xuanwu Lake, the Sun Yat-sen Mausoleum and the Confucius Temple. Its sprawling and grand parks and green spaces rank #32 in our Nature & Parks subcategory. Nature and heritage blend seamlessly in Nanjing. The city's Purple Mountain is a verdant oasis of trails and cultural sites, while Xuanwu Lake provides serene waterfronts amid bustling urban life. The Yangtze River, threading through the city, is both a lifeline and a picturesque backdrop.

But Nanjing isn't content to rest on its laurels—it's a city that consistently redefines itself. Ranked #26 on the Prosperity index, Nanjing exemplifies economic vitality driven by software development and modern services. In 2024, the city unveiled an ambitious commercial aerospace initiative, aiming to dominate sectors like satellites and space exploration. This forward-looking strategy complements the 7,000 tech companies already flourishing here, nurtured by a talent pool of over four million. Nanjing's GDP growth is staggering, surpassing US\$117 billion in the first half of 2024 and earning it the #27 spot in GDP per Capita. Its unemployment rate, ranking #12, underscores a thriving job market that continues to attract young professionals.



55 Kochi India

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 10 Tree Cover
- 14 Instagram Hashtags

POPULATION

Metro 2,381,000

History is being made (again) in India's southwest.

Kochi, a historic coastal city on India's southwest, stands as a unique blend of its rich colonial past and rapid modernization. Strolling through the streets of Fort Kochi, visitors encounter Portuguese, Dutch and British architectural remnants that reflect its role as a global maritime trade hub. The iconic Chinese fishing nets, towering along the coast, offer a glimpse into Kochi's centuries-old fishing traditions, while the spice markets buzz with activity, a testament to the city's enduring role in international trade. Heritage landmarks like the ancient Jewish Synagogue and St. Francis Church make Kochi a living museum. Small wonder the city ranks #30 for its Sights & Landmarks and #10 for its lush Tree Cover.

Equally remarkable is Kochi's urban transformation. The second phase of the Kochi Metro, now extending from JLN Stadium to Kakkanad, is rapidly advancing, significantly easing traffic and contributing to the city's impressive #45 ranking for Livability. Economic growth is bolstered by the US\$1.2-billion Smart City Project, a joint venture between Dubai Holding and Kerala's government, with its US\$56-million IT tower set to create thousands of jobs, which will improve Kochi's current #84 Prosperity ranking.



56 Zhuhai China

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 12 Unemployment Rate
- 19 Fortune 500

POPULATION

Metro 2,313,000

An economic engine powered by proximity to Hong Kong and Macau.

Zhuhai, long regarded as one of China's most beautiful coastal cities, has leveraged its strategic location to become a significant player on the global stage. The city's unique positioning as the gateway between mainland China, Hong Kong and Macau is epitomized by the Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macau Bridge, a 34-mile engineering marvel that seamlessly connects these major economic hubs. This infrastructure not only underlines Zhuhai's importance as a logistical crossroads but also enhances its appeal as a top-tier tourist destination. The city's scenic allure, from the iconic Lovers' Road to the symbolic statue of the Zhuhai Fisher Girl gazing over the water of Xianglu Bay, has helped secure its #59 ranking in our overall Livability index, including #23 in our Air Quality subcategory. Economically, Zhuhai's status as a Special Economic Zone continues to drive its prosperity. Since 2023, the city has accelerated its industrial development, with a focus on sectors such as smart manufacturing, new energy and high-tech industries. A robust business environment has Zhuhai ranking #45 in Prosperity, helped by the city's favorable government policies, including tax breaks and subsidies for innovation. Investment to keep the party going continues, including the recent plans to expand the city's airport into a major regional aviation hub by 2030.



57 Nanning China

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 12 Unemployment Rate
- 23 Healthcare System Index

POPULATION

Metro 3,249,000

A strategically located city is a gateway for China's economic future.

Renowned for its pristine air, this southern Chinese city has become known for "Nanning Blue", a reference to both its air quality (ranking #50) as well as its draw of talent and investment. Also dubbed China's Green City, Nanning boasts a forest coverage rate of 43.81%, securing #30 in our Tree Cover subcategory. The city's commitment to green living is further facilitated by its year-round mild climate as much as by its sustainability kudos—which include being named China's inaugural National Ecological Garden City and a pilot metropolis for "sponge city" rainwater and flood management projects and investments. As China's closest provincial capital to the headquarters of the Association of Southeast Asian Nations in Jakarta, Nanning has carved out a vital role as the gateway for China-ASEAN co-operation, propelling the city to an impressive #54 in our overall Prosperity index. In recent years, Nanning has been on a transformative journey, reshaping its urban landscape with the development of its metropolitan area. The city has identified electronic information, advanced equipment manufacturing and biomedicine as the engines driving its economic ascent. With the completion of the Pinglu Canal in 2026, Nanning will unveil the most efficient sea route to the Beibu Gulf, setting the stage for a new era in urban form and industrial innovation.



58 Changsha China

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 8 Convention Center
- 10 Unemployment Rate

POPULATION

Metro 5,065,000

The capital of Hunan province channels its academic history to define its economic future.

Known for Yuelu Academy—one of the world's oldest academic institutions—Changsha is a city steeped in cultural heritage that also has impressive natural beauty, best experienced on Orange Island where the Xiang River offers breathtaking views. Culinary connoisseurs are drawn to Changsha's bold, spicy Xiang cuisine, and visitors can take home a piece of the city's rich cultural history in the form of Xiang embroidery. The heritage of erudite elegance has positioned Changsha on a path to economic vitality, ranking #30 in our overall Prosperity pillar. With a #36 ranking in our GDP per Capita subcategory, the city is attracting domestic and international investors such as BYD, Gree and Sany Heavy Industry, positioning it as a manufacturing and logistics hub. The local government is courting investment in high-tech manufacturing, automotive industries and new energy, with plans for over US\$6 billion in investments by 2027. This influx of investment has bolstered the city's reputation as a prime location for talent and capital alike. A focus on strengthening infrastructure like public transit to meet the needs of its growing population, which has surged by three million in the past decade, is a priority over the coming decade, as young professionals are drawn to the 10th-lowest unemployment in our ranking and continue streaming into the city.



59 Qingdao China

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 12 Convention Center
- 21 Healthcare System Index

POPULATION

Metro 6,291,000

China's coast with the most.

This sprawling metropolis wrapping the massive bay of Jiaozhou Wan on the Yellow Sea is home to more than 6 million residents on China's northeast coast. Revered nationally as the country's premier marine sports hub, thanks to its crystal-clear waters, the city boasts a #29 ranking in our Nature & Parks subcategory, with local destinations like the Zhanqiao Pier, the majestic Mount Laoshan and the vibrant May Fourth Square much-loved symbols of the city's allure. And let's not forget the Qingdao International Beer Festival, an event so grand it pulls visitors from all corners of the globe, cementing the city's growing status as a must-visit destination domestically and internationally.

But local ambitions reach far beyond tourism. Qingdao has also become a leader in marine innovation, hosting 30% of the nation's oceanic research institutions, focusing on fisheries, cutting-edge marine equipment, and revolutionary pharmaceuticals and biopharma. And the future looks even brighter—Qingdao is gearing up to invest a staggering US\$28 billion into key marine projects, further igniting the city's economic engine. No wonder it ranks #32 in our overall Prosperity index. With a convention center ranking of #12 and a #28-ranked airport, Qingdao is inviting the world to "sea" the marine economic miracle for themselves.



60 Da Nang Vietnam

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 4 Unemployment Rate
- 10 Nightlife

POPULATION

Metro 1,366,000

Vietnam's coastal jewel knows the jobs to be done.

Da Nang has emerged as one of Vietnam's most dynamic cities, blending its bucolic natural bounty with rapid city-building. Positioned along Vietnam's central coast, its stunning stretches of sandy beaches have become major tourist draws. My Khe Beach, often lauded as one of the most beautiful beaches in Southeast Asia, has helped Da Nang secure a strong tourism foundation. Tourists and locals alike are drawn to its calm waters, as well as nearby attractions such as the Marble Mountains, endowing the city with a #38 ranking in our overall Lovability index.

New hospitality developments, including luxury resorts and international hotel brands, continue to double down on Da Nang's magnetism, reflected in its Top 10 position in Nightlife and Top 25 for Tripadvisor Reviews. Economically, Da Nang is at the forefront of Vietnam's drive to become a global innovation hub. The city boasts the fourth-lowest unemployment rate in our ranking and is increasingly attracting foreign investment, especially in the technology and manufacturing sectors, boosted by the 2022 completion of the Da Nang Hi-Tech Park. With more than US\$2 billion in investment, companies like Universal Alloy Corporation and Fujikin have already established significant operations here. Good thing the Da Nang International Airport (currently ranked #87) is expanding in 2026.



61 Thrissur India

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 10 Tree Cover
- 12 Rent

POPULATION

Metro 1,578,000

The cultural heartbeat of Kerala and India's gold capital.

Hailed as the cultural capital of Kerala on India's southwest coast, Thrissur is steeped in tradition as home to the renowned Thrissur Archaeological Museum and the stunning murals of Vadakkunnathan Temple. Then there's the grand festivals, particularly the famous Thrissur Pooram, often considered Kerala's most spectacular, during which the city hosts majestic elephant parades, colorful parasols and the rhythmic drumbeats of the chenda, drawing visitors from across the globe. Spiritual landmarks, such as the ancient Vadakkunnathan Temple, the Bible Tower—the tallest church tower in Asia—and the Cheraman Juma Masjid, India's first mosque, located nearby in Kodungallur, exemplify Thrissur's religious diversity and its harmonious coexistence of faiths.

The city is also a gem of livability (#27), boasting a Top 10 ranking for tree cover, a Top 20 for healthcare and impressive housing affordability. All this in addition to being known as the country's gold capital and a major commercial hub in South India. Key projects aim to keep a good thing going. The Integrated Public Transport System (IPTS) and the development of the Thrissur Ring Road are improving mobility and connectivity, while the Heritage City Development and Augmentation Yojana (HRIDAY) project is preserving Thrissur's cultural landmarks while modernizing its infrastructure.



62 Varanasi India

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 2 Price-to-Income Ratio
- 6 Rent

POPULATION

Metro 3,229,000

Life runs deep in one of the world's oldest continuously inhabited cities.

Nestled along the sacred Ganges River, Varanasi's stepped riverbanks teem with life, rituals and stories that span millennia. From the ethereal Ganga Aarti at Dashashwamedh Ghat (bank) to the labyrinthine streets of the old city adorned with temples and bustling markets, Varanasi bares India's soul like nowhere else. Its cultural significance is reflected in its ranking of #37 in our Sights & Landmarks subcategory. But it's the city's impressive healthcare (ranked #35) and affordability that powers it to a #33 ranking in our overall Livability index. But the future is equally coveted here. The city's ambitious Smart City Mission is reshaping urban infrastructure with smart lighting, public Wi-Fi and real-time water quality monitoring. The revitalization of Kashi Vishwanath Corridor, connecting the iconic temple to the river banks, has bolstered its appeal to both pilgrims and tourists. The city has also invested in sustainable development, including projects to clean the Ganges and improve public transport, ensuring its heritage remains accessible and preserved. Economically, Varanasi is evolving beyond its traditional identity as a center for silk weaving and craftsmanship. The city is attracting investments in tourism, education and renewable energy. Varanasi's Banaras Hindu University, a leading institution in India, fosters academic and cultural exchange, contributing to the city's intellectual vibrancy.



63 Ningbo China

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 24 Unemployment Rate
- 27 Tree Cover

POPULATION

Metro 4,383,000

A maritime legacy fuels an economic powerhouse.

Ningbo, a city of profound historical and economic significance on China's eastern seaboard, is quietly asserting its role as a leader in both culture and commerce. Known for the Tianyi Pavilion, the oldest surviving private library in China, Ningbo has long stood as a cradle of intellectual achievement. It is no accident that this city, once the starting point of the ancient Maritime Silk Road, continues to serve as a strategic hub in global trade. Its Zhoushan Port, the world's third-largest container port, is an enduring testament to Ningbo's logistical prowess, reflected in its strong ranking of #44 in our overall Prosperity index. Ningbo's economic ascent is underscored by its recent GDP figures, which reached more than US\$241 billion in 2023, placing the city at #31 in our GDP per Capita subcategory. As the financial heart of Zhejiang Province, Ningbo's robust industrial base—ranging from high-tech manufacturing to green energy initiatives—drives much of its economic strength. The city's government has set ambitious targets to transform Ningbo into a global innovation hub by 2025, particularly focusing on industries like artificial intelligence, robotics and advanced manufacturing. These efforts are supported by both domestic and international investment, which will further boost the city's #24 spot in our Unemployment Rate subcategory.



64 Hiroshima Japan

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 2 Tree Cover
- 9 Air Quality

POPULATION

Metro 1,098,000

A city of resilience and renewal is investing in its citizens and legacy.

Hiroshima, a city that has long been a symbol of devastation and renewal, is an under-appreciated urban dynamo resiliently marching towards doing right by its citizens. One of the smallest cities in our ranking, at just over a million people, Hiroshima's ongoing urban planning initiatives aim to further enhance its green spaces (it ranks #2 in our Tree Cover subcategory and #9 for Air Quality), public transport, and business and tech infrastructure like the Hiroshima Innovation District (HID). Set for completion by 2028, HID aims to create a hub for technology, research and education in the heart of the city, attracting both domestic and international talent. The expansion of Hiroshima's Mass Rapid Transit (MRT) system is another key to its livability. The hospitality and tourism sectors are also growing as investors and visitors discover this ascendant city. Several new luxury hotels have recently opened, including the Hiroshima Marriott and Hilton Hiroshima, with plans to further develop key attractions such as Itsukushima Shrine and Hiroshima Peace Memorial Park. The city's unique culinary scene is also finally getting its just desserts, particularly its renowned Okonomiyaki, a savory pancake dish consisting of wheat flour batter and other ingredients.



65 Dehradun India

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 19** Price-to-Income Ratio
- 22** Healthcare System Index

POPULATION

Metro 1,136,000

The Gateway to the Himalayas is today a rising investment hub.

Nestled in the foothills of the Himalayas, Dehradun offers its million-something residents cool mountain air, lush green surroundings and Top 25-ranked Tree Cover. The city's pride as a livable sanctuary is reflected in its #29 ranking in our overall Livability index. Yes, the Rajaji National Park and Malsi Deer Park, along with other green spaces such as Gandhi Park, offer residents an outdoor lifestyle that is hard to rival in India. Recent urban development projects have enhanced this connection to nature by expanding green spaces and creating eco-friendly infrastructure, making Dehradun a haven for those who seek serenity alongside modern amenities. But it's the city's #19-ranked Price-to-Income Ratio, #22-ranked Healthcare System and #32-ranked Rent that truly deliver on its reputation as India's hidden gem. Economic prosperity is also on its way, with connectivity and the planned Dehradun-Delhi Expressway significantly reducing the travel time between the two cities. Government officials increasingly tout Dehradun's safety and attractiveness as an investment destination, with new investment proposals worth approximately US\$2.4 billion prioritizing tourism, renewable energy and infrastructure development. Dehradun's cultural and educational heritage is equally rich. Prestigious institutions like The Doon School and the Indian Military Academy continue to shape the city's intellectual landscape.



66 Colombo Sri Lanka

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 17** Shopping
- 17** Nightlife

POPULATION

Metro 3,532,000

Sri Lanka's kinetic capital wants much more.

Colombo, the pulsing capital of Sri Lanka, is as naturally endowed as it is culturally rich, with colonial-era architecture, bustling markets and scenic coastline worthy of the heart of the island nation. Iconic landmarks ranging from the historic Colombo Fort to the seaside Galle Face Green are key attractions for both locals and visitors. Not surprisingly the city is a cultural, culinary and festive playground, from its vibrant street food (try the spicy isso vade prawn fritters) to the elegant tea cafés such as Dilmah's t-Lounge offering a luxurious way to experience the island's world-class infusions. Then there's the kinetic (and #17 ranked) nightlife and shopping (ranging from the bustling Pettah Market to the new One Galle Face Mall) that helps drive Colombo's impressive #44-ranked overall Lovability, with many of the epic urban experiences captured by the #29-ranked Tripadvisor reviews. Colombo's #71-ranked Livability should also improve with urbanscape investments like the Megapolis Project, focusing on public transport, housing and green spaces, that are enhancing Colombo for citizens. Many of today's city-building initiatives—to reduce traffic congestion, improve public transport options and increase green areas—should be ready by the end of the decade. And keep the #22-ranked Air Quality breathable.



67 Kozhikode India

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 4** Rent
- 10** Tree Cover

POPULATION

Metro 3,049,000

A historic trading hub gets ready for its closeup on the Malabar Coast.

Kozhikode, known globally by its colonial name Calicut, is a city where the Arabian Sea meets centuries of maritime innovation. Situated on Kerala's Malabar Coast, Kozhikode's legacy as the gateway to India's spice trade has left an indelible mark on global commerce and culture. It was here in 1498 that Vasco da Gama first landed, heralding an era of European exploration and colonial interest in India. The city's bustling markets, still rich with the aromas of spices, seafood and local produce, evoke its vibrant trading past, offering a sensory journey into its heritage. Kozhikode thrives as a melting pot of influences from the Arab, Chinese and European traders who once graced its shores. From the historic Mishkal Mosque to Kappad Beach, Kozhikode offers a visual and cultural feast, securing a notable #28 ranking for Instagram Hashtags. Ranked an impressive #44 in our overall Livability index, Kozhikode's commitment to enhancing quality of life is evident in projects like "Green Kozhikode," which bolsters its impressive Top 10 ranking for Tree Cover. Public spaces such as Mananchira Square and the Sarovaram Biopark offer lush retreats amid the urban sprawl, while Kozhikode Beach remains a vibrant hub for locals and visitors alike. The fourth-lowest Rent in our ranking leaves more means to enjoy it all.



68 Surabaya Indonesia

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 10 Instagram Hashtags
- 29 Google Trends

POPULATION

Metro 6,556,000

There's lots to love in Indonesia's second city.

Surabaya, Indonesia's second-largest city and the capital of East Java, is a jewel of colonial heritage (don't miss the iconic Hotel Majapahit and the sprawling Tugu Pahlawan – Heroes Monument). But with its strategic location as a major port city and a dynamic center for trade, it is a vital contributor to Indonesia's current and future economic aspirations. Foreign investment has also recognized the opportunity and the city has attracted substantial funds from South Korea and Japan, particularly in the manufacturing and technology sectors. Key developments include the expansion of the Surabaya Industrial Estate Rungkut (SIER), which aims to attract global players in the electronics and automotive industries. The launch of the Surabaya-Lamongan Maritime Corridor is also expected to enhance logistics and trade, further cementing the city's role as a maritime hub. Don't expect the middling #88 ranking in our overall Prosperity index to stay that low for long. Especially with the ongoing hospitality boom, with luxury properties such as the Westin Surabaya, complete with world-class dining and event spaces, enhancing its appeal for both business and leisure travelers. The ongoing expansion of Juanda International Airport (currently ranked #71) promises to further boost tourism, positioning Surabaya as a gateway for international visitors to Indonesia. Expect the impressive Instagram Hashtag (#10) and Google Trends (#29) rankings to only improve.



69 Kathmandu Nepal

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 16 Facebook Check-ins
- 22 Tripadvisor Reviews

POPULATION

Metro 3,247,000

Nepal's outdoor mecca is rebuilding tourism and livability post-pandemic.

The capital of Nepal has for centuries served as the gateway to the Himalayas. Known for its UNESCO World Heritage sites, including Durbar Square and the Swayambhunath Stupa, Kathmandu is a vibrant city where ancient traditions coexist with contemporary urban life and a steady torrent of global visitors keen to blend their adrenaline pursuits with the country's revered spirituality. Sandwiched between towering summits and deep jungles, it's no wonder the city ranks #35 in our overall Lovability index. Its UNESCO-protected Sights & Landmarks rank #39 and Nature & Parks are #24, but an overall middling Livability ranking of #73 needs attention. Luckily, Kathmandu is embarking on a journey of urban renewal and modernization. The Kathmandu Valley Development Program, launched in 2022, focuses on improving infrastructure, including road expansion, public transport upgrades and urban beautification projects. By 2025, the program aims to enhance Kathmandu's livability, addressing challenges such as traffic congestion and air quality, for which the city currently ranks #91. Tourism remains Kathmandu's economic backbone, and by 2030 the Kathmandu Ring Road Expansion Project and upgrading of Tribhuvan International Airport (it's currently ranked #63 in our Airport Connectivity subcategory) will significantly enhance the city's connectivity, supporting both tourism and trade.



70 Tiruchirappalli India

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 9 Price-to-Income Ratio
- 9 Healthcare System Index

POPULATION

Metro 1,131,000

An ancient river city plugs into the renewables wave.

Tiruchirappalli, often referred to as Trichy, stands as a testament to Tamil Nadu state's rich cultural heritage and its forward-looking development agenda. Known for the towering Rockfort Temple and the awe-inspiring Ranganathaswamy Temple on Srirangam Island, this ancient river city is rapidly modernizing, powered by its stealthy Livability (for which it ranks #43), Top 10 rankings for Price-to-Income Ratio and Healthcare System, and its #15 ranking for Rent. The affordability and social safety net has long nurtured a growing hub for education, industry and urban innovation. These days urban infrastructure investments are happily building on a good thing. The Smart City Mission has introduced a host of projects, including smart traffic systems, upgraded public transport and the redevelopment of Gandhi Market into a state-of-the-art commercial hub. The Trichy Corporation's Green Initiatives have added eco-friendly buses to the city's fleet and expanded much-needed tree cover in urban zones. The city is also home to Bharat Heavy Electricals Limited (BHEL) and a growing cluster of manufacturing industries. The Tamil Nadu government's Industrial Investment Plan has earmarked Trichy as a focal point for renewable energy projects and small-scale engineering enterprises, drawing significant investment from multinational companies based in Germany and South Korea. Expect its relatively small population to grow in short order.



71 Tianjin China

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 27 Museums
- 30 GDP per Capita

POPULATION

Metro 10,047,000

The pursuit of the finer things in one of China's ascendant second cities.

Tianjin's Fifth Avenue-level of grandeur and cultural bounty rivals any city in our ranking, while its Goubuli steamed buns headline a stealthy culinary scene. Home of the centuries-old xiangsheng, a comedic art form of crosstalk or comic banter akin to stand-up comedy, the city has long exported performers all over China. And its cultural heritage also stands out, with Tianjin's Museums ranking #27 and its Sights & Landmarks #36. Beyond its cultural roots, the city is rapidly transforming, with urban development and economic investment poised to redefine its landscape through the rest of the decade. As a key part of the Beijing-Tianjin-Hebei (Jing-Jin-Ji) economic megaregion, Tianjin's strategic location makes it a crucial hub for innovation and industry. The city has embraced high-tech sectors, focusing on new energy vehicles, urban rail transit and smart manufacturing. These initiatives have not only driven Tianjin's GDP to US\$11.5 billion in 2023 (and a Top 30 GDP per Capita spot in our ranking) but have also attracted significant investment from domestic and international companies. The city is also unveiling several transformative urban development projects, from Tianjin Binhai New Area, a major economic zone to facilitate finance, high-tech manufacturing and shipping, to the expansion of its Meijiang Convention and Exhibition Center.



72 Hefei China

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 12 Unemployment Rate
- 30 Convention Center

POPULATION

Metro 5,052,000

Freshwater bounty and quantum frontiers converge in China's rising innovation hub.

Hefei, once celebrated for its cultural landmarks like Chaohu Lake, Baogong Park and the former residence of Li Hongzhang, is today a city promoting groundbreaking technological advancements to secure its place among China's second cities. The city's ambitious strides in quantum technology have earned it global recognition, specifically for its quantum metropolitan area network—the first of its kind in the world. It's an advanced communication system that leverages the principles of quantum mechanics to enable ultra-secure data transmission across a city or metropolitan area that surpasses traditional encryption methods. Complementing this is a thriving manufacturing sector, where over 20% of the world's consumer electronic LCDs and one out of every 12 new energy vehicles in China are produced. These achievements anchor Hefei's position as a critical player in the global supply chain, powering its #52 ranking in our overall Prosperity index. And Hefei's economic trajectory is set to accelerate even further. Volkswagen will open its largest R&D center outside of Germany by 2027, solidifying Hefei as a hub for the new energy vehicle industry. This aligns with the city's strategic vision to dominate the sector, supported by giants like NIO and JAC Motors. Expect the impressive #12 Unemployment Rate to plummet even more.



73 Guwahati India

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 5 Price-to-Income Ratio
- 41 Labor Force Participation

POPULATION

Metro 1,355,000

A small urban jewel in India's north keeps it boutique.

Guwahati, once known as the Gateway to Northeast India, is shedding its laid-back provincial image to emerge as one of India's most dynamic and ascendant smaller urban centers. Nestled along the mighty Brahmaputra River that flows from the Himalayas, and surrounded by lush, rolling hills, Guwahati is as much a cultural cornerstone as it is an economic dynamo. Giants like Reliance, Tata and Patanjali have cemented their presence here, while DHL and Blue Dart leverage Guwahati's strategic location as a logistics hub for the entire Northeast region. The city's industriousness and entrepreneurship certainly helps, ranking #41 in our Labor Force Participation subcategory. As does its remarkable affordability and Top 5 Price-to-Income Ratio ranking. Good thing the Lokpriya Gopinath Bordoloi International Airport is expanding, sure to improve on its current #83 spot. Culturally, Guwahati's heart beats in its heritage sites like Kamakhya Temple and its vibrant festivals, including Bihu, which connect its urban dynamism to centuries-old traditions. Initiatives such as eco-friendly water taxis on the Brahmaputra and the planned Brahmaputra Riverfront Development Project underscore the city's commitment to blending heritage with sustainability. There's also a hospitality boomlet, with new luxury hotels like the upcoming Taj Guwahati aligning with ongoing plans to attract more high-spending tourists.



74 Naha Japan

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 16 Air Quality
- 16 GDP per Capita

POPULATION

Metro 1,104,000

A small but mighty gateway to Okinawa's cultural bounty.

As the capital of Okinawa Prefecture, Naha is the beating heart of Japan's southernmost islands, where the subtropical climate and rich cultural history have crafted an urban sanctuary loved domestically and often overlooked internationally. Known for its vibrant energy and traditional Ryukyu culture, Naha is a truly distinct Japanese experience, from the iconic Shuri Castle (a UNESCO World Heritage site) to the lively markets and Okinawan delicacies of Kokusai Street. Naha's laid-back coastal vibe is balanced with its importance as a gateway to the Okinawa archipelago, providing access to pristine beaches and coral reefs just a short ferry ride away. With its special blend of history and nature, it's no surprise that Naha ranks highly for Air Quality (#16), Tree Cover (#21) and Heat Stress (#29). The city's underwhelming Sights & Landmarks ranking (#57) should ascend after the Shuri Castle Reconstruction Project restores one of Naha's most iconic landmarks following a devastating fire in 2019. Additionally, the opening of several high-end hotels, including the Hyatt Regency Naha and Halekulani Okinawa, has expanded the city's luxury accommodation offerings. Good thing that Naha's airport is getting a long-overdue expansion by 2030 to become the aviation hub between Japan and Southeast Asia. The city's #16 GDP per Capita will only strengthen when it does.



75 Kannur India

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 10 Tree Cover
- 15 Healthcare System Index

POPULATION

Metro 1,360,000

Golden beaches and the good life mean you'll be hearing about Kannur a lot more.

Kannur, serenely situated on Kerala's stunning golden Malabar Coast between Goa to the north and Kochi to the south, is a city you'll be hearing a lot more about over the next decade. Long renowned for its exquisite handloom fabrics and its role in India's colonial history, the city's natural beauty and beach vibe tranquility are reflected in its impressive #35 ranking in our overall Livability index. But in addition to pristine beaches like Payyambalamm historic landmarks such as St. Angelo Fort and a Top 10 ranking for Tree Cover, Kannur also boasts the 15th-best Healthcare System in our ranking.

Today's Kannur is leveraging its coveted (if undiscovered) natural bounty into economic resilience, with initiatives like the expansion of the Kannur International Airport set to enhance its connectivity and attract trade and tourism through direct links to the Middle East and other global markets. The airport's establishment has already spurred a 40% increase in regional exports, particularly in textiles and coir products. The city is also investing in eco-tourism, with projects such as the Valapattanam River Tourism Project enhancing the appeal of its natural waterways. There are also plans for a Cultural Heritage Corridor to connect key sites, preserving Kannur's historical and artistic legacy while boosting its tourism economy.



76 Ahmadabad India

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 23 Google Trends
- 23 Facebook Check-ins

POPULATION

Metro 8,006,000

The vibrant financial capital of Gujarat is connecting to its future.

As one of India's first planned cities, Ahmedabad's layout reflects the vision of its founder, Sultan Ahmed Shah, in 1411. Today, Ahmedabad continues to redefine itself as a nexus of culture, commerce and connectivity. The metropolis ranks #50 in our overall Lovability index, and is packed with architectural treasures, including the intricately carved Sidi Saiyyed Mosque and the sprawling Sabarmati Ashram, that evoke its illustrious past. The UNESCO World Heritage designation of Ahmedabad's walled city has further cemented its position as a global cultural beacon that boasts matching #23 rankings in both our Google Trends and Facebook Check-ins subcategories. Beyond its heritage, Ahmedabad's urban development projects signal a city in motion. The Sabarmati Riverfront Development, a visionary urban renewal project, has transformed once-neglected riverbanks into vibrant public spaces, enhancing both livability and property values across the city. Transport infrastructure is at the heart of Ahmedabad's future growth. The Ahmedabad Metro, set to expand significantly by 2026, is designed to alleviate urban congestion and connect key business hubs with residential zones. And the upcoming bullet train project linking Ahmedabad to Mumbai will reduce travel times to under three hours, integrating the city more closely with the broader western economic corridor.



77 Changchun China

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 11 Heat Stress
- 19 Fortune 500

POPULATION

Metro 3,387,000

Industrial power and tech-forward innovation bridge rich heritage with a plan to own the future.

Changchun, known as the cradle of China's automotive and film industries, is synonymous nationally with innovation. But while home to the China FAW Group, one of the country's largest automobile manufacturers, and the historic Changchun Film Studio, this northeastern city isn't confined to its industrial roots; it's in the midst of a dynamic reinvention that underscores its role as a modern economic and cultural hub. The city's ambition is clear in its pursuit of a high-tech future, particularly in optoelectronic technology (industrializing the science of light). Changchun's bold initiative to establish a billion-dollar optoelectronic industry cluster within three years highlights its focus on sectors like integrated circuits, lasers, satellite applications and the industrial internet. This cutting-edge development places Changchun firmly on the map as a rising 21st-century tech hub and one of China's fastest-growing second cities. Not surprisingly, it ranks #58 in our overall Prosperity index. In 2023, the city reported robust 6% GDP growth, while 2024 continued this momentum with growing national and global investment and surging import-export volume and retail sales. Culturally, Changchun holds its own, too. The renowned Changchun Film Festival celebrates its cinematic heritage, while performances of Er Ren Zhuan, a vibrant folk art popular in northeastern China, connect visitors to its traditions.



78 Jinan China

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 2 Convention Center
- 12 Fortune 500

POPULATION

Metro 4,057,000

The City of Springs flows in balance with natural beauty and economic ambition.

Famous for its 72 artesian springs, which bubble within urban parks and ancient temples, Jinan is a stealthy metropolis of parks, streams and rivers whose beauty rivals anything else in China. Sites like Baotu Spring, Daming Lake and the Thousand Buddha Mountain offer locals and visitors alike a serene escape from the city's bustling streets. It's #55 ranking for Nature & Parks will rightly improve as the world discovers Jinan's stealthy beauty and wonderful climate (the city ranks #33 for Heat Stress). But Jinan is more than its picturesque springs. The capital of Shandong Province is rapidly evolving into an economic and technological powerhouse with a thriving industrial base and burgeoning tech sector that boasts the 12th-most Fortune 500 companies and second-best convention center in our ranking. New investment by AI and pharmaceutical research companies and the city's talent-attraction programs like the Jinan Start-Up Area for Growth Drivers Transformation, launched in 2023, are only going to improve the city's already impressive #15 ranking in our overall Prosperity index. Culturally, the city's dozens of ancient temples (many hidden in urban forests) are getting the preservation they deserve, and the newly renovated Shandong Museum and Confucius Cultural Park draw history enthusiasts eager to explore China's philosophical roots.



79 Salem India

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 1 Price-to-Income Ratio
- 35 Fortune 500

POPULATION

Metro 1,189,000

A city of craftspeople leverages its special blend for the world.

Salem, nestled at the foot of the majestic Shevaroy Hills, has long been recognized as the textile capital of India's southern state of Tamil Nadu. Known domestically for its iconic Salem Steel Plant, vibrant handloom sarees, and ancient temples such as the Sugavaneshwarar Temple and Kottai Mariamman Temple, Salem exudes a unique blend of tradition and enterprise. The city's strategic location, acting as a gateway to Tamil Nadu's western corridor, has positioned it as a hub for the commerce and culture that contribute to its impressive #38 ranking in our overall Livability index, led by its #1 spot for Price-to-Income Ratio. That affordability, for better or worse, has been a strategic advantage for the handloom and garment industries employing thousands and contributing significantly to India's exports. The Tamil Nadu Industrial Policy 2025 has earmarked Salem for growth in sustainable textile manufacturing and green industrial practices, drawing significant investment in solar-powered looms and eco-friendly production techniques. The city is also expanding its industrial base into sectors like automotive components and renewable energy. The local economy will also ascend with the Chennai-Salem Expressway, expected to be operational by 2026, that should slash travel time to the state capital while spurring economic activity along its route.



80 Mysore India

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 6 Price-to-Income Ratio
- 16 Rent

POPULATION

Metro 1,296,000

India's City of Palaces prioritizes the bounty of an educated citizenry.

Deep in the heart of south India, at the base of the Chamundi Hills, Mysore is a city where time appears to slow, allowing its cultural and historical wealth to gradually reveal itself. The City of Palaces is synonymous with architectural splendor, including the luminous Mysore Palace, a kaleidoscope of Indo-Saracenic grandeur illuminated nightly to the delight of locals and visitors alike. These and many other distinct attributes (including its #53-ranked Museums) drive the city's #45 Google Trends and #54 Instagram Hashtags subcategory rankings. The city's Gothic-style St. Philomena's Cathedral and bustling lanes of Nazarbad capture the city's colonial past and multi-religious present. But portals back in time like the Devaraja Market, filled with fragrant garlands, freshly ground spices and vibrant vegetables, contrast sharply with the burgeoning IT hubs in the Hebbal Industrial Area. Here, the Infosys Global Education Center, one of the world's largest corporate training campuses, hints at Mysore's aspirations to remain more than a postcard of its past. A focus on IT and education has placed the city on a slow but steady economic ascent, made possible by its relative affordability (#6 for Price-to-Income Ratio and #16 for Rent). That balance results in an impressive #60 ranking in our overall Livability index.



81 Raipur India

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 15 Price-to-Income Ratio
- 35 Fortune 500

POPULATION

Metro 1,429,000

A crossroads of ancient commerce builds links to optimize its next millennium.

Long known for its vibrant, street-level commerce like Pandri Market and Gol Bazaar, where handwoven fabrics, tribal jewelry and fresh produce reflect Chhattisgarh's cultural and agricultural heritage, Raipur has its crafty eye set on the future. The ambitious Nava Raipur Atal Nagar project is a cornerstone of this transformation. Located just 20 kilometers from the historic core, this smart city development is reshaping the region's urban landscape with sustainable housing, cutting-edge IT parks and new government offices. Designed to prioritize green infrastructure, the project includes solar energy installations, dedicated cycling tracks and abundant green spaces that complement its modern skyline. The aim is clear: to position Raipur as a symbol of balanced growth where progress doesn't need to eclipse tradition (but certainly needs to leverage its #35 ranking for Fortune 500 companies and #47-ranked Labor Force Participation). Investment is pouring into Raipur's infrastructure. Projects include an indoor stadium to boost local sports, a sprawling IT complex, and an expanded network of roads and cycle tracks to enhance mobility. These developments align with Raipur's improving overall Livability index ranking of #58. Cultural initiatives remain central to Raipur's identity, with many tribal art festivals and music events annually. Additionally, the Purkhouti Mukangan open-air museum offers an immersive experience of the region's crafts, rituals and folklore.



82 Harbin China

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 9 Heat Stress
- 27 Airport Connectivity

POPULATION

Metro 3,869,000

China's historic Ice City is a stealthy tourism hotspot on a warming continent.

Harbin, often celebrated for its European allure, stands out with its distinctive Baroque, Byzantine and Gothic architecture, marking it as one of China's most iconic historical and cultural cities (ranking #41 in our Museums subcategory). With its extreme winters, where temperatures routinely plunge below -20° F, the city is forging a unique climate identity (and a #9 ranking in our Heat Stress subcategory) that has become a powerful draw for domestic tourists fleeing the increasingly warming Chinese capitals, with the Harbin International Ice and Snow Sculpture Festival emerging as a must-visit event. Local delicacies like Guo Bao Rou (sweet and sour pork) and frozen pears are a bonus. The growing visitor numbers speak for themselves—over the 2024 New Year holiday, the city welcomed a staggering three million visitors. Looking ahead, Harbin is set to host the 9th Asian Winter Games in February 2025, a high-profile event that will invigorate its tourism-driven economy even further. This surge in visitor numbers has propelled Harbin to #50 in our Prosperity ranking. Despite its long, harsh winters, the city enjoys mild summers complemented by an impressive forest coverage rate of 41.5%, helping the city rank #34 in our Tree Cover subcategory.



83 Dongguan China

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 10 Convention Center
- 12 Unemployment Rate

POPULATION

Metro 10,753,000

The World's Factory rides its prosperity to become a coveted hometown.

Once a magnet for global merchants sourcing goods, Dongguan is now investing heavily in elevating its urban appeal, blending its industrial strength with cultural offerings and enhanced livability. While its reputation as a manufacturing hub remains unchallenged—thanks to 190,000 industrial enterprises and a staggering trade volume surpassing US\$140 billion in 2023—the city is evolving into a more holistic urban center. It now ranks #70 in our overall Prosperity index. The city's rich cultural heritage, represented by landmarks like the Humen Fort and the ancient Nanshe Village, draws both tourists and locals. Food lovers flock to Dongguan for its famed roast goose. Yet Dongguan's most significant investment lies in urban development aimed at enhancing the quality of life of its 10 million-plus residents. With a focus on creating child-friendly environments, Dongguan ranks #79 in our overall Livability index, led by its #28-ranked Air Quality and #39 spot for Tree Cover. Recent developments include the expansion of Dongguan Metro, which aims to connect more suburban areas to the city's bustling core, making commuting and getting around more convenient than ever. Dongguan's position as a logistics hub is also set to improve with planned upgrades to its port infrastructure that will make it a crucial link in the Greater Bay Area.



84 Haikou China

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 16 Airport Connectivity
- 41 Air Quality

POPULATION

Metro 2,566,000

Natural splendor meets bold ambition on Hainan's sunlit shores.

Haikou, the "Coconut City" of China's southern Hainan Island, is redefining its role as a tropical getaway. Its sweeping coastlines and visa-free entry for travelers from 59 countries lay the foundation for its rising appeal, but it's the city's seamless blend of history, nature and forward-looking development that makes it one to watch. From the historic charm of Qilou Old Street, a vibrant vestige of Haikou's past, to the ecological marvel of the Dongzhai Port Mangrove Natural Reserve, Haikou offers a multifaceted experience that captivates residents and visitors alike. At the forefront of Haikou's evolution is its bold approach to urban development. The city's 2024 agreement to create an International Agricultural Industry Park signals a new era of innovation, aiming to position Haikou as a leader in sustainable food production. In retail, the Haikou International Duty-Free City Shopping Complex, the world's largest single-building duty-free mall, is transforming the city into a global shopping destination (for which it currently ranks #105 but is sure to improve). Transportation is a major focus, with plans for eight metro lines spanning almost 100 miles by 2030. This comprehensive network will not only enhance urban mobility but also solidify Haikou's place as a gateway to greater China and beyond, which will only boost its already impressive #35 ranking in our overall Prosperity index.



85 Pattaya Thailand

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 2 Unemployment Rate
- 11 Labor Force Participation

POPULATION

Metro 1,126,000

A party town on the eastern Gulf of Thailand grows up.

Once synonymous with raunchy nightlife and beachside revelry, Pattaya is growing into a dynamic hub of leisure, investment and sustainable urban development. While its famed Walking Street still pulses with energy, Pattaya now offers a more nuanced allure, blending natural beauty, cultural heritage and ambitious modern projects fueled by talent attracted by its low unemployment and high labor force participation rates. The city's beaches, including Jomtien and Naklua, are undergoing revitalization efforts to enhance their appeal to families and eco-conscious travelers alike, and Pattaya's #75 ranking for Nature & Parks will likely improve as a result. Pattaya's transformation extends to infrastructure and urban growth. The Eastern Economic Corridor (EEC) initiative, backed by significant government investment, positions the city as a critical economic and logistics hub in Southeast Asia. A major highlight is the development of the U-Tapao International Airport, set to become Thailand's third-largest aviation hub by 2027, complementing high-speed rail connections linking Pattaya to Bangkok and other major cities. These projects aim to make Pattaya a key node in Thailand's future-ready economic network. Tourism is also being elevated, with new luxury hotels like the InterContinental Pattaya Resort and the One Pattaya mixed-use development redefining upscale tourism. The city's #46 overall Lovability index ranking will only improve with higher-yield visitor arrivals.



86 Kitakyushu Japan

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 9 Air Quality
- 17 GDP per Capita

POPULATION

Metro 1,611,000

A sustainability-obsessed rebirth on Japan's south coast.

While Kitakyushu ranks #9 in our Air Quality subcategory and #21 for Tree Cover, things weren't always so green and clean. After World War II, Kitakyushu's heavy industry, particularly steel production, polluted the city's air and water, with smoke-belching factories and toxic waste turning its coast into an environmental disaster zone. By the 1960s, residents could barely see the sun through the smog, and the once-bountiful Dokai Bay was dubbed the "Sea of Death" due to industrial runoff. In the 1980s local governments, citizens and businesses launched a series of bold environmental reforms, including stricter emissions regulations, investment in pollution control technologies and the revitalization of industrial waste management systems. The city's Eco-Town project, initiated in the late 1990s, became a model for sustainable urban development. It encouraged recycling, waste-to-energy projects and eco-friendly businesses, attracting global attention and investment. Today, Kitakyushu's ongoing "Smart City" initiative integrates energy-efficient technologies and renewable energy systems into its infrastructure. This, along with the development of the Kitakyushu Eco-Town, positions the city as a hub for green and sustainable industries. These zones are designed to attract foreign and domestic companies focused on recycling, renewable energy and low-carbon technologies.



87 Medan Indonesia

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 12 Instagram Hashtags
- 25 Facebook Check-ins

POPULATION

Metro 4,027,000

The capital of North Sumatra has long reveled in its melting pot of cultures and industries.

Historically a hub for international trade, Medan today continues to thrive as an economic powerhouse and gateway to the island's vast natural wonders. It ranks #34 for its Air Quality and #35 for Tree Cover. Its strategic location on the Malacca Strait positions it as a vital player in Indonesia's connectivity and trade networks, making it a focal point for investment and development.

Medan's diverse heritage is its soul. The city's cultural vibrancy reflects a blend of Malay, Batak, Chinese, Indian and Dutch influences. Landmarks like Maimun Palace, a relic of the Deli Sultanate, and the stunning Tjong A Fie Mansion, a historic Chinese-European architectural gem, offer visitors a glimpse into its storied past. Medan's culinary scene is equally captivating, with iconic dishes such as soto Medan, bika ambon, and nasi goreng drawing food enthusiasts from around the world (which may explain the impressive #12 Instagram Hashtags ranking). Economic development is accelerated by infrastructure projects like the Kuala Tanjung Port, which aims to become a major regional maritime hub, while the Kualanamu International Airport Expansion Project will position Medan as a key aviation gateway. The government's focus on building a seamless Medan-Deli Serdang Metropolitan Area is creating new opportunities for commerce and urban living.



88 Vadodra India

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 13 Price-to-Income Ratio
- 33 Unemployment Rate

POPULATION

Metro 2,182,000

Echoes of the past and wheels of steel into the future.

Walking through the city's wide, tree-lined streets, the grandeur of Vadodra's history is palpable. At the center of it all is Laxmi Vilas Palace, a sprawling estate built in 1890 by the visionary Gaekwad dynasty. Still home to the royal family, the palace's gilded interiors and manicured grounds symbolize Vadodra's cultural and architectural heritage. But the city, known locally as Baroda, is no museum piece. It's alive, dynamic and transforming at a pace that few might expect from a place steeped in so much history. And with its relative affordability, it also boasts an impressive #67 spot in our overall Livability index. Strategically positioned along the Delhi-Mumbai Industrial Corridor (DMIC), the city is becoming a magnet for industrial and technological investment. Its chemical and engineering industries hum with activity, powered by giants like ONGC and Larsen & Toubro, and its pharmaceutical sector is emerging as a hub of innovation. The recent establishment of a Technology and Innovation Hub promises to bolster the city's role in India's industrial future, powered by its healthy unemployment rate (#33) and engaged labor force (#43). The Vadodra Metro Rail Project, slated for completion by 2026, promises to make commuting smoother for its expanding population, while the Ahmedabad-Vadodra-Mumbai High-Speed Rail corridor will connect the city to India's economic hubs in record time.



89 Agra India

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 17 Healthcare System Index
- 21 Rent

POPULATION

Metro 2,737,000

The home of the Taj Mahal is an entrepreneurial dynamo trying to do right by its citizens.

For most, Agra is synonymous with the Taj Mahal, that enduring monument to love and architectural perfection. But the city, straddling the banks of the Yamuna River, is striving to balance its Mughal-era grandeur with the demands of modern urban life. Start with a stroll through Mehtab Bagh, the riverside garden perfectly aligned with the Taj Mahal. At dusk, locals and tourists mingle here, captivated by the symmetry of Shah Jahan's masterpiece mirrored in the Yamuna's waters. They'll document their experiences in the #30-ranked Tripadvisor Reviews and the #35-ranked Facebook Check-ins. Nearby, the Agra Fort, a UNESCO World Heritage site, whispers tales of emperors and intrigue. Economic ambition courses through Agra's industrial hubs, where small and medium enterprises specialize in leather goods, marble inlay work and handicrafts. The Taj Leather Cluster has become a vital economic engine, employing thousands and exporting products globally. Efforts are underway to expand the city's reach, with the Agra Metro, expected to launch by 2025, promising to transform urban mobility and enhance connectivity for its residents. Additionally, investments like the Agra Smart City Project are revamping infrastructure, including better water management and renewable energy projects, while the Heritage Street Redevelopment Plan has revitalized the pathways leading to the Taj Mahal.



90 Malang Indonesia

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 11 Nature & Parks
- 23 Instagram Hashtags

POPULATION

Metro 1,620,000

A cultural oasis blooms amid volcanoes and coffee plantations.

Tucked between the volcanic peaks of Mount Bromo and Mount Semeru, Malang is a city with #11-ranked Nature & Parks cooled by fresh mountain air (#28), rich Javanese culture and colonial-era architecture. Often overshadowed by its more famous neighbors the island of Bali and the city of Surabaya, Malang is quietly carving out its place as a destination in East Java. Malang's Kampung Warna-Warni Jodipan, a once-neglected riverside neighborhood transformed into a vibrant, Instagrammable kaleidoscope of colors (hence the #23 Instagram Hashtags ranking), is a testament to the city's creative spirit. Nearby, the Ijen Boulevard, with its Dutch colonial houses and shaded boulevards, offers a glimpse into Malang's colonial past. Yet it's not all nostalgia. Economically, Malang thrives as East Java's hub for education and agriculture. Home to prestigious institutes of higher education like Brawijaya University, it draws young talent from across Indonesia, while its fertile lands support thriving coffee plantations producing some of the country's best brews, attracting a growing number of agro-tourists eager to experience its famed kopi robusta. The Malang-Pandaan Toll Road, completed in 2024, has significantly improved access to Surabaya and beyond, enhancing connectivity for both residents and tourists. Plans for a new integrated transport hub, set to open by 2026, promise to make Malang an even more accessible destination in East Java.



91 Davao City Philippines

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 17 Air Quality
- 17 Labor Force Participation

POPULATION

Metro 1,379,000

A sprawling urban center pulses with life and opportunity in the southern Philippines.

Known as the Crown Jewel of Mindanao for its breathtaking natural surroundings at the foot of the majestic Mount Apo—the country's highest peak—Davao thrives as a gateway to adventure and economic opportunity in the region. The city has consistently topped national safety indices and boasts expansive green spaces, including the People's Park and the sprawling Eden Nature Park. Davao is also home to the Philippine Eagle Center, dedicated to the conservation of the country's national bird, and offers pristine diving spots off nearby Samal Island. Ranking #17 for its Air Quality and #61 for Tree Cover, the city ranks an impressive #63 in our overall Livability index. Economically, Davao is booming. Powered by its #17-ranked Labor Force Participation, the city continues to attract foreign and domestic investments, especially in agribusiness and information technology. The Davao City Investment Promotion Center recently reported a 15% increase in foreign direct investment between 2022 and 2024, underscoring its growing appeal as a regional economic hub. Notable developments like the Davao Global Township and the Azuela Cove mixed-use project are transforming the cityscape with luxury residential spaces, retail hubs and commercial centers. The city's culinary scene is equally captivating, with fresh produce from its fertile lands shaping its gastronomic identity.



92 Cebu Philippines

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 17 Labor Force Participation
- 23 Air Quality

POPULATION

Metro 2,482,000

The Queen City of the South is transforming into a premier economic and tourism hub.

Cebu is building on its centuries as a cultural stronghold into a major economic and tourism player. As the Philippines' oldest city, Cebu's Spanish colonial heritage is evident in landmarks like Magellan's Cross and the Basilica del Santo Niño. But this is also a metropolis on the rise and the tech sector continues to be a major driver, with Cebu IT Park and Cebu Business Park serving as focal points for both multinational companies and start-ups. In 2022, Cebu's economy received a significant boost with the opening of the Cebu-Cordova Link Expressway, a US\$800-million project that enhances connectivity between Cebu and Mactan Island, where dozens of boutique hotels and beachfront resorts are opening to cater to international tourists. This key infrastructure development is expected to unlock further investment in both industrial and commercial real estate, and validate Mactan-Cebu International Airport's US\$330-million second terminal expansion as the country's second-largest air gateway (currently ranking #65). But local tourism is already ascendant. In 2023, the highly anticipated NUSTAR Resort and Casino opened, marking the first integrated casino resort outside of Manila. The luxury development includes a world-class convention center, upscale hotels and entertainment venues that will finally embolden the historical heart of the Philippines to level up to the capital.



93 Bhubaneswar India

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 25 Rent
- 35 Fortune 500

POPULATION

Metro 1,112,000

The Temple City of India marches toward modernity.

With more than 700 temples dotting its landscape, including the iconic Lingaraj Temple and Rajarani Temple, Bhubaneswar is a living museum of Odisha's storied past (with a #81 ranking for its actual museums). As one of India's first cities selected under the national Smart Cities Mission, Bhubaneswar has embraced technology to enhance public services, from intelligent traffic management systems to robust waste management initiatives. The Bhubaneswar Town Centre District, an integrated urban project, aims to create walkable, mixed-use neighborhoods that blend tradition with 21st-century convenience. The city's evolving infrastructure, including a planned expansion of Biju Patnaik International Airport (currently ranked #84) and upgraded rail links, will connect new visitors and talent. With Odisha's government committed to attracting US\$50 billion in investments by 2030, Bhubaneswar is poised for a new era of economic and cultural renaissance, especially given its relative affordability. Bhubaneswar has also emerged as a hub for IT and education and is home to prestigious institutions like the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) and Xavier Institute of Management (XIMB), fostering a steady flow of talent into the #52-ranked local Business Ecosystem. Major IT firms like Infosys and Tech Mahindra have established significant operations here attracting investment in cutting-edge sectors.



94 Coimbatore India

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 27 Rent
- 34 Google Trends

POPULATION

Metro 2,551,000

"South India's Manchester" weaves its industrial strength with cultural elegance.

Coimbatore is where entrepreneurial spirit meets sacred ancient traditions against the backdrop of the Western Ghats in Tamil Nadu. This hub of commerce, innovation and culture has long had its industrial backbone rooted in textiles, machinery and precision engineering, earning it global recognition. Today, Coimbatore is a powerhouse, with a stronghold in textiles, IT services and the emerging electric vehicle sector. The Coimbatore-Tirupur Industrial Corridor, supported by the Tamil Nadu government, is poised to attract foreign direct investment, positioning the city as a critical hub in India's manufacturing and export economy and sure to improve the city's #35 Fortune 500 ranking. The region's well-established educational institutions, like PSG College of Technology, further bolster its talent pipeline, feeding skilled professionals into its growing industries. The city's temple-dotted grid, gilded with religious landmarks like Marudhamalai Temple and the sprawling Isha Yoga Center, home to the iconic Adiyogi Shiva statue, add spiritual depth to Coimbatore's identity and help its #60 Sights & Landmarks ranking. The city's green spaces, like the verdant Race Course Road and the scenic Kovai Kutralam waterfalls, offer respite to residents and visitors alike. Meanwhile, nightlife hubs and luxury developments like the Vivanta Coimbatore cater to a growing cosmopolitan audience eager to spend the spoils of the #41-ranked Business Ecosystem.



95 Lucknow India

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 8 Facebook Check-ins
- 23 Google Trends

POPULATION

Metro 4,661,000

The capital of Uttar Pradesh is a lovable feast of the senses.

Lucknow has long been synonymous with exquisite craftsmanship, classical music and the gentle art of refined hospitality. Walking through its bustling streets, you'll find remnants of its regal past, from the awe-inspiring Bara Imambara, an 18th-century architectural marvel, to the intricate chikankari embroidery that has made the city a global name in fashion. No wonder Lucknow ranks an impressive #36 in our overall Lovability index. The #8-ranked Facebook Check-ins and #23-ranked Google Trends are helped by the city's food scene, celebrated for its kebabs and biryanis, as well as a packed festivals calendar featuring events like the Lucknow Mahotsav, a showcase of rich local heritage, from Kathak performances to poetry recitals in Urdu. And Lucknow is making it easy to gather here. The Gomti Riverfront Park and revamped Janeshwar Mishra Park offer tranquil escapes, reflecting the city's focus on enhancing public spaces and quality of life, while the construction of a new integrated bus terminal and the expansion of Lucknow Metro will improve connectivity for its four-million-plus residents and growing number of visitors. Lucknow is also leveraging its strategic location as a logistics hub for North India. The Uttar Pradesh government's US\$80-billion investment goal for infrastructure by 2028 is fueling sectors such as IT, electronics and defense manufacturing.



96 Gwalior India

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 8 Price-to-Income Ratio
- 8 Rent

POPULATION

Metro 1,477,000

Elevated and ancient urbanism in northern India's high plains.

Perched strategically on the northern plains of Madhya Pradesh, Gwalior's history is in your face: its skyline is dominated by the imposing 1,300-year-old Gwalior Fort, called the "pearl among fortresses in India" (think the Acropolis in Athens to the power of 10!). A masterpiece of Rajput architecture, the fort offers a glimpse into the city's storied past as a royal stronghold. The Jai Vilas Palace, home to the Scindia dynasty, and the echoes of the composer Tansen's musical legacy solidify Gwalior's cultural reputation. Today, it is the required visitor must-see and hosts elevated public spaces and parks, that, along with green spaces like Phool Bagh and the rejuvenated Tighra Dam help the city's #61 ranking in our overall Livability index. The relatively affordable cost of living helps, too.

The Gwalior-Chambal Expressway should bolster the city's connectivity, making it a key player in North India's logistics and trade networks. Meanwhile, the talent pool is ready for future investment, as Gwalior has emerged as a center of learning, with institutions like the Scindia School and Indian Institute of Information Technology (IIIT) producing a pipeline of skilled professionals. Plans for a new medical research institute and a dedicated IT park in the city aim to diversify its economic base, drawing investment and talent from across India.



97 Suzhou China

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 12 Unemployment Rate
- 19 Fortune 500

POPULATION

Metro 6,091,000

The Venice of the East is a torrent of innovation.

Suzhou, renowned for its UNESCO World Heritage gardens like the Humble Administrator's Garden and the Lingering Garden, offers a window into China's classical aesthetic and architectural mastery often obscured by the country's rapid modernization. Strolling along the serene canals or beneath the arching willows of Tiger Hill, it's easy to see why Suzhou has earned its moniker as the Venice of the East (and ranks #30 for Nature & Parks). This is a city where heritage thrives—captured in the delicate Su embroidery, Suzhou Pingtan performances and the exquisite flavors of Biluochun tea and Yangcheng Lake's renowned hairy crabs. Suzhou also ranks #44 for Sights & Landmarks, complemented by contemporary icons like the Suzhou Museum of art and design, designed by starchitect I.M. Pei, and the Suzhou Center Mall, a stunning blend of retail and recreation.

But Suzhou is also an economic powerhouse of more than six million. With a staggering GDP of US\$336 billion in 2023 and a per capita GDP of more than US\$25,000, Suzhou has the 12th-lowest unemployment rate in our ranking. The city's economic drive is fueled by its robust manufacturing and technology sectors dominated by many of the #19-ranked Fortune 500 companies and underpinned by 830,000 private enterprises, which generate over 80% of local employment.



98 Ipoh Malaysia

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 6 Tree Cover
- 15 Labor Force Participation

POPULATION

Metro 1,036,000

Nestled between Kuala Lumpur and Penang, a Malaysian star rises.

Radiating with the natural beauty of its limestone caves and old-world architecture, Malaysia's fifth-largest city is a beguiling, lush web of vibrant coffee shops (don't miss Nam Heong White Coffee), local cuisine (the moonlight noodles at Tuck Kee!) and heritage buildings that is increasingly attracting a growing number of curious tourists. The city is a walkable feast, boasting the #6 ranking for Tree Cover and #23 for Air Quality, which both contribute to its #64 ranking in our overall Livability index. Expect Ipoh to ascend even further with increasing urban rejuvenation like the Ipoh Riverfront Development Project that is expanding the riverfront with parks, cycling paths and food hubs.

Ongoing investment in leading tourist attraction Lost World of Tambun, a jungle-ensconced theme park peppered with natural hot springs, continues to draw families from across Malaysia and Asia, contributing to Ipoh's growing hospitality sector. Ipoh's blooming economy is supported by its diversity, with key sectors such as agriculture and manufacturing rounding out tourism. The Kinta District Smart City Initiative, part of Malaysia's broader Smart City plan, aims to further modernize Ipoh by 2030. The initiative focuses on integrating smart technology in transportation and green energy solutions, tapping into the city's #15-ranked Labor Force Participation.



99 Guiyang China

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 14 Convention Center
- 18 Heat Stress

POPULATION

Metro 4,269,000

Keeping it cool and stable while welcoming China's innovators.

Surrounded by striking karst formations and lush low-lying mountains, Guiyang captivates visitors with its breathtaking natural landmarks, including the Nanjiang Grand Canyon, Zijiang Rift and the serene Bailong Cave, all the better to explore in the city's cool, subtropical climate. Ranking #50 for Air Quality and #18 for Heat Stress, Guiyang offers a refreshing escape from sweltering summers, while the city's forest coverage, exceeding 55% (and ranking #43 in our Tree Cover subcategory), ensures abundant green spaces. Guiyang's over 1,000 parks—including the sprawling Qianling Park—make it a haven for those seeking tranquility. These qualities have made Guiyang increasingly popular with retirees, who are drawn to its balanced urban ecosystem and serene environment.

The climate (and geological stability) is also drawing industry, elevating the city's overall Prosperity index ranking to an impressive #33. Giants like Huawei have established 21 data centers here, bolstering Guiyang's reputation as a leader in cloud computing and big data. The city's ambitious plans include creating three industrial clusters valued at almost US\$14 billion each, positioning Guiyang as a key player in China's second-city growth. The city is also a talent magnet due to its cultural mosaic, home to 48 ethnic minority groups whose vibrant traditions infuse the city with color and vitality year-round.



100 Lahore Pakistan

PLACE POWER™ HIGHLIGHTS

- 5 Facebook Check-ins
- 14 Rent

POPULATION

Metro 13,504,000

Affordability, creativity and growing investment help Pakistan's second city take flight.

Pakistan's cultural capital reveals its ancient history with every step, from the Mughal-era landmarks like the grand Badshahi Mosque to its intricate Lahore Fort and the serene Shalimar Gardens. Lahore's #40 Sights & Landmarks ranking is testament to centuries of architectural and artistic excellence. The city's poetic soul finds expression in its rich literary traditions, with iconic names like Faiz Ahmed Faiz and Allama Iqbal rooted in its cultural fabric. The bounty inspires millions of modern storytellers who give the city a Top 5 Facebook Check-ins ranking and #17 spot for Instagram Hashtags. Lahore's relative affordability only helps in drawing artists and bards of a new generation. They come for ancient inspiration, of course, but also for the bustling bazaars such as Anarkali and Liberty Market that offer everything from handcrafted textiles to aromatic spices. Food lovers flock to the famous Gawalmandi Food Street, where the smoky flavors of kebabs and the tang of Lahori fish evoke the city's culinary mastery. With a GDP per capita rank among the highest in Pakistan, the city has become a magnet for domestic and foreign investment, from new transit to green spaces across the city. Lahore's burgeoning IT sector further underscores its role as a national economic engine.

Ranking cities' Place PowerTM Score, by category

RANK	CITY	COUNTRY	LIVABILITY	LOVABILITY	PROSPERITY	POPULATION
1	Singapore	Singapore	2	2	1	5,926,000
2	Tokyo	Japan	1	1	3	37,785,000
3	Seoul	South Korea	3	5	5	23,225,000
4	Hong Kong	China	4	4	8	6,468,000
5	Beijing	China	13	12	2	18,883,000
6	Bangkok	Thailand	14	3	13	18,884,000
7	Sydney	Australia	5	7	9	4,836,000
8	Shanghai	China	28	11	4	24,042,000
9	Melbourne	Australia	6	9	14	4,709,000
10	Kuala Lumpur	Malaysia	11	14	12	9,387,000
11	Osaka	Japan	7	13	20	14,916,000
12	Delhi	India	54	8	10	31,190,000
13	Mumbai	India	40	6	17	25,189,000
14	Bangalore	India	30	15	11	15,257,000
15	Auckland	New Zealand	10	26	36	1,537,000

RANK	CITY	COUNTRY	LIVABILITY	LOVABILITY	PROSPERITY	POPULATION
16	Taipei	Taiwan	12	18	46	9,662,000
17	Guangzhou	China	52	51	6	27,119,000
18	Shenzhen	China	50	52	7	17,778,000
19	Brisbane	Australia	15	24	21	3,039,000
20	Perth	Australia	18	25	22	2,101,000
21	Nagoya	Japan	8	42	39	9,439,000
22	Sapporo	Japan	9	39	55	2,168,000
23	Jakarta	Indonesia	93	10	29	35,386,000
24	Hangzhou	China	32	47	16	9,618,000
25	Busan	South Korea	23	34	42	3,843,000
26	Adelaide	Australia	25	37	41	1,271,000
27	Fukuoka	Japan	24	41	43	2,368,000
28	Hanoi	Vietnam	83	16	48	6,359,000
29	Johor Bahru	Malaysia	26	83	31	2,040,000
30	Chengdu	China	55	56	18	15,016,000
31	Penang	Malaysia	22	31	76	1,704,000
32	Chongqing	China	39	74	23	12,653,000
33	Kunming	China	46	99	19	4,995,000
34	Chennai	India	37	22	64	11,570,000
35	Ho Chi Minh City	Vietnam	75	17	62	14,953,000
36	Pune	India	41	23	60	6,819,000
37	Sendai	Japan	21	79	63	1,280,000
38	Xiamen	China	34	87	28	5,253,000
39	Xi'an	China	49	62	27	12,211,000
40	Wuhan	China	53	84	24	10,353,000
41	Phnom Penh	Cambodia	88	29	25	2,196,000
42	Kolkata	India	70	19	69	21,747,000
43	Hyderabad	India	42	33	65	9,797,000
44	Taichung	Taiwan	17	60	132	2,517,000
45	Kaohsiung	Taiwan	20	68	104	2,346,000
46	Fuzhou	China	36	123	37	4,487,000
47	Jaipur	India	62	20	86	4,360,000
48	Denpasar	Indonesia	31	48	77	1,326,000
49	Dalian	China	57	97	34	4,177,000

RANK	CITY	COUNTRY	LIVABILITY	LOVABILITY	PROSPERITY	POPULATION
50	Tainan	Taiwan	19	75	134	1,118,000
51	Kollam	India	16	118	142	1,576,000
52	Bandung	Indonesia	56	21	124	7,203,000
53	Manila	Philippines	78	40	49	24,156,000
54	Nanjing	China	97	72	26	8,507,000
55	Kochi	India	45	45	84	2,381,000
56	Zhuhai	China	59	134	45	2,313,000
57	Nanning	China	51	139	54	3,249,000
58	Changsha	China	82	117	30	5,065,000
59	Qingdao	China	86	85	32	6,291,000
60	Da Nang	Vietnam	48	38	98	1,366,000
61	Thrissur	India	27	107	123	1,578,000
62	Varanasi	India	33	64	107	3,229,000
63	Ningbo	China	76	120	44	4,383,000
64	Hiroshima	Japan	72	65	61	1,098,000
65	Dehradun	India	29	105	126	1,136,000
66	Colombo	Sri Lanka	71	44	74	3,532,000
67	Kozhikode	India	44	80	89	3,049,000
68	Surabaya	Indonesia	80	30	88	6,556,000
69	Kathmandu	Nepal	73	35	93	3,247,000
70	Tiruchirappalli	India	43	122	101	1,131,000
71	Tianjin	China	106	86	40	10,047,000
72	Hefei	China	87	128	52	5,052,000
73	Guwahati	India	47	109	99	1,355,000
74	Naha	Japan	77	91	67	1,104,000
75	Kannur	India	35	115	127	1,360,000
76	Ahmadabad	India	92	50	72	8,006,000
77	Changchun	China	90	127	58	3,387,000
78	Jinan	China	136	119	15	4,057,000
79	Salem	India	38	121	138	1,189,000
80	Mysore	India	60	76	119	1,296,000
81	Raipur	India	58	102	102	1,429,000
82	Harbin	China	108	94	50	3,869,000
83	Dongguan	China	79	124	70	10,753,000

RANK	CITY	COUNTRY	LIVABILITY	LOVABILITY	PROSPERITY	POPULATION
84	Haikou	China	113	136	35	2,566,000
85	Pattaya	Thailand	85	46	96	1,126,000
86	Kitakyushu	Japan	91	114	66	1,611,000
87	Medan	Indonesia	68	43	139	4,027,000
88	Vadodara	India	67	78	100	2,182,000
89	Agra	India	74	57	118	2,737,000
90	Malang	Indonesia	65	53	136	1,620,000
91	Davao City	Philippines	63	93	112	1,379,000
92	Cebu	Philippines	89	70	80	2,482,000
93	Bhubaneswar	India	66	89	114	1,112,000
94	Coimbatore	India	81	77	92	2,551,000
95	Lucknow	India	110	36	83	4,661,000
96	Gwalior	India	61	111	135	1,477,000
97	Suzhou	China	104	81	73	6,091,000
98	Ipoh	Malaysia	64	90	130	1,036,000
99	Guiyang	China	128	130	33	4,269,000
100	Lahore	Pakistan	114	27	113	13,504,000

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